



CITY: PG 3

CM aims to transform Delhi into tourist hotspot



NATION: PG 5

MP boat tragedy: Death toll rises to 11



FILM: PG 12

'Wanted to do something different'

US WARNS SHIPS ON IRAN TRANSIT PAYMENTS | CONFLICT LIKELY TO RESUME: IRAN

Pay Iran, pay the price: US

We're like pirates: Trump on US seizing Iranian oil from ships in Hormuz

ASSOCIATED PRESS

BEIRUT: The United States is warning shipping companies they could face sanctions for making payments to Iran to safely pass through the Strait of Hormuz.

The US Office of Foreign Assets Control alert posted Friday adds pressure in the standoff between the US and Iran over control of the strait at the mouth of the Persian Gulf, where about a fifth of the world's trade in oil and natural gas typically passes.

Iran effectively closed the strait by attacking and threatening ships after the US and Israel launched a war on Feb 28. It later began offering some ships safe passage by detouring them through routes closer to



its shore, charging fees at times.

That "tollbooth" effort is the focus of the US sanctions warning, which said payment

demands could include transfers not only in cash but also "digital assets, offsets, informal swaps, or other in-kind

payments," including charitable donations and payments at Iranian embassies.

The US responded to Iran's

closure of the strait with a naval blockade of Iranian ports on April 13, preventing Iranian tankers

Continued on P4

GULF FLASHPOINT

» US President Donald Trump said that the US Navy is acting like 'pirates' in waters and boasted about how operations take place while seizing ships amid the blockade of Iranian ports

» 'We ... land on top of it and we took over the ship. We took over the cargo, took over the oil. It's a very profitable business'

» President Trump has rejected Iran's latest proposal to end the war

RE-POLL IN 15 BOOTHS CONCLUDES, NEARLY 87% TURNOUT TILL 5 PM

'Falta seat to go for re-poll on May 21, results on May 24'



Security personnel stand guard as voters wait in a queue to cast their votes at a polling station during a re-poll at Magrahat West Constituency, on Saturday

PIIC/PTI

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Re-polling was conducted peacefully in 15 booths across Diamond Harbour and Magrahat West in South 24-Parganas on Saturday, but the exclusion of Falta from the list triggered protests and tension in the area.

Meanwhile, in a major development, the Election Commission of India (ECI) on Saturday declared that the elections held on April 29 at Falta Assembly Constituency in South 24-Parganas were void.

The apex poll body announced that fresh polls will be held in all the 285 polling stations in Falta, including auxiliary ones, on May 21, and the result of the same will be declared on May 24.

Now, with a re-poll at Falta

TURNOUT

» The overall voting percentage available from 14 of the 15 booths till 5 pm was 86.90 with Diamond Harbour registering 87.60 per cent and Magrahat Paschim 86.11 per cent

» A good number of migrant workers who had come for voting on Wednesday could not cast their franchise during the repoll, as they had to return for work

after the counting, the declaration of the result in that Constituency will be withheld on the day of the counting scheduled on May 4.

The poll body on Friday had scheduled re-polling at 11 booths

Continued on P4

Judicial officer dies by suicide; probe underway

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: A Delhi Judicial Services official allegedly died by suicide in Safdarjung area here, police said on Saturday.

According to a preliminary inquiry, the deceased -- identified as Aman Kumar Sharma -- is suspected to have died by hanging, they said.

A police team reached the spot after receiving information about the incident and initiated inquest proceedings.

The body has been sent for post-mortem, officials said, adding that further investigation is underway.

"No foul play has been established so far. However, all angles are being examined as part of inquest proceedings," a senior police officer said.

According to official records, Sharma had joined the Delhi Judicial Services on June 19, 2021. A law graduate from Symbiosis Law School, Pune, he completed his BA LLB in 2018. During his tenure, he dealt with a range of criminal and civil cases and served in different jurisdictions as a judicial magistrate first class (JMFC) and civil judge.

With effect from October 18, 2025, Sharma had taken charge as the Full-Time Secretary of the District Legal Services Authority (DLSA) in the North-East district at Karkardooma Courts.

Police said statements of concerned persons are being recorded and relevant circumstances leading to the incident are being examined.

TMC NAMES DIST REPS TO GUARD AGAINST COUNTING IRREGULARITIES

Mamata tells agents to ignore exit polls, stay till end



OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: Trinamool Congress (TMC) supremo Mamata Banerjee and national general secretary Abhishek Banerjee on Saturday held a virtual meeting with counting agents from 291 of 294 Assembly constituencies, with the party chairperson urging them to

stay put till counting ends and asserting the party will cross 200 seats.

The Anit Thapa-led Bharatiya Gorkha Prajatantrik Morcha (BGPM) contested the remaining three seats in the Darjeeling hills.

"Do not give importance to the numerous exit polls telecast on TV channels and social

media. We are winning. Don't leave counting stations till I give clearance, even if it is 2 o'clock in the night," Mamata said.

She also said those party workers who fought for the past 6 months in the face of adversity unleashed by a section of state police and Central Forces

Continued on P4

Defuse turns fatal: Four cops killed

IED goes off mid-defuse

PRESS TRUST OF INDIA

KANKER: Four police personnel, including an inspector of the District Reserve Guard (DRG), were killed after an improvised explosive device (IED) went off while they were trying to neutralise it during a demining operation in Chhattisgarh's Kanker district on Saturday, police said.

This was the first blast incident linked to Naxalite activity in the state since it was declared free from armed Maoism on March 31. It was also the first instance this year in which security personnel engaged in anti-Naxal operations have lost their lives.

The explosion occurred around 11.30 am in a forest area of Aadnar village under Chhotebethiya police station limits, near the Narayanpur district border, when a joint team of security personnel was conducting a demining operation to locate and defuse IEDs planted earlier by Naxalites, Inspector General of Police, Bastar Range Sundarraj Pattilingam told PTI.

Based on the inputs received from surrendered Maoist cadres and other intelligence over the past few months, security forces had recovered and neutralised hundreds of IEDs planted earlier by Naxalites across the Bastar range, which comprises seven districts including Kanker, he said.

Saturday's operation was launched following similar inputs about Maoist dumps in the Chhotebethiya area. The team, led by the DRG, also included

Continued on P4

'POLITICAL VENDETTA', SAYS BJP

Pathak in FIR net after switch

MPOST BUREAU

CHANDIGARH/NEW DELHI: The Punjab Police has booked Rajya Sabha MP Sandeep Pathak, who recently quit the AAP to join the BJP with six of his colleagues, sources said on Saturday.

Two FIRs have been lodged against Pathak under non-bailable sections, they said.

No further details about the FIRs have been disclosed yet.

Pathak was among the seven Rajya Sabha MPs who quit the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) recently.

A Punjab police team went to Delhi but Pathak had already left his residence in a sports utility vehicle (SUV) before its arrival. In a video, Pathak was seen leaving his residence when some journalists approached him for his reaction to the development.

Pathak, a former professor at the Indian Institute of Technology (IIT),

KEY POINTS

» Two FIRs have been lodged against Pathak under non-bailable sections

» No further details about the FIRs have been disclosed yet

» Pathak was among the seven Rajya Sabha MPs who quit the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) and joined the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) recently

Delhi, was credited with drafting the AAP's election and campaign strategy and building the party organisation. Once considered close to AAP supremo Arvind Kejriwal, Pathak played a significant role in the party's triumph in the 2022 Punjab Assembly polls.

The development comes close on the heels of a raid conducted by the Punjab Pollution Control Board at the premises of

Continued on P4

Pune: 4-yr-old raped, murdered; 65-yr-old held

PUNE: A 65-year-old man with criminal record has been arrested for allegedly sexually assaulting and murdering a four-year-old girl in Bhor tehsil of Pune district, police said on

Saturday, as the incident led to angry protests in the area.

The accused, who works as a labourer, allegedly lured the girl with the promise of food on Friday and took her to

a cattle enclosure where he sexually assaulted her and later killed her by hitting her with a stone, said a police official.

He was arrested on the basis of CCTV footage from

Continued on P4

COUNTING SUPERVISOR CASE

Implement circular in true letter & spirit: SC tells EC

OUR CORRESPONDENT

KOLKATA: After the Trinamool Congress (TMC) approached the Supreme Court of India seeking permission to include Bengal government employees as counting supervisors on election day, the apex court on Saturday observed that the Election Commission of India (ECI) would "implement the circular dated April 13, 2026, in true letter and spirit".

"No further orders are necessary in this case except to record the statement of Mr Dama Seshadri Naidu that the Election Commission will

THE CASE

» TMC Belegghata Candidate Kunal Ghosh alleged that an additional Chief Electoral Officer in Bengal had issued a communication, allegedly to "appease" the BJP, stating that only central government employees would be deployed as counting supervisors and assistants

» TMC chose not to challenge

the circular but sought its proper implementation

» 'The key point is the random selection of state and central government employees... This means both can be appointed for counting duties'

» Earlier, the Calcutta High Court upheld the Election Commission's decision to appoint central government and PSU employees as counting supervisors

implement the circular dated April 13, 2026 in true letter and

spirit," the order said. "With these

Continued on P4

Govt appoints Rohit Jain as RBI Deputy Governor

MPOST BUREAU

NEW DELHI: The government has appointed Rohit Jain as Deputy Governor of the Reserve Bank of India for a three-year term.

Jain is replacing T Rabi Sankar, whose extended tenure ended on Saturday.

The Appointments Committee of the Cabinet has approved his appointment for a period of three years from the date of joining the post on or after May 3, sources said on Monday.

Continued on P4



India should create strategic buffers to tackle toughest energy shock: CEA

‘Rising prices of fertiliser & petroleum products globally will make it challenging to achieve the 4.3% fiscal deficit target for the current fiscal’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran on Saturday said India needs to create strategic buffers in the face of the “most difficult” energy shock that the country is facing amid the West Asia crisis.

Nageswaran also said the rising prices of fertiliser and petroleum products globally due to the crisis will make it challenging to achieve the 4.3 per cent fiscal deficit target for the current fiscal, while below normal monsoon and pass-through of higher energy prices could lead to “potential inflation spike”.

He also said India has employment challenge emanating from AI, and there is a need to ensure that IT sector becomes more competitive and not lose jobs to AI, and instead create jobs that use AI within the IT sector or in other services.

Speaking at the ICPG Growth Conference organised by the Ashoka University, Nageswaran said the current account deficit (CAD) in the current fiscal could rise to over 2 per cent of GDP, from less than 1 per cent in FY26.

“The ... priority for us is to



Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran

He also said India has employment challenge emanating from AI, and there is a need to ensure that IT sector becomes more competitive and not lose jobs to AI, and instead create jobs that use AI within the IT sector or in other services

create strategic buffers. This energy shock is the most difficult one compared to any other previous energy shock in terms of energy lost as a percentage of total global energy supply, not just oil, including gas.

“And we also need to use this occasion to think about other areas where we are vulnerable in terms of import dependence, nickel, tin, and copper. We need to build strategic buffers if we have to make a shot at manufacturing and becoming indispensable,” Nageswaran said.

Since the beginning of the war in West Asia on February 28, crude oil prices soared to a four-year high of \$126 per barrel on Thursday, from about \$73 level before the war.

Stating that geopolitics will compel policymakers to be nimble and flexible and

shed old model of thinking, Nageswaran said India is better prepared than many other countries to deal with the crisis because of the fiscal leeway that the country has due to lowering of fiscal deficit ratio to 4.4 per cent of GDP in FY26.

Nageswaran said the West Asia conflict is more of a price shock than supply shock for India as the government is managing the supply side deftly.

Key Points

» Nageswaran said the current account deficit (CAD) in the current fiscal could rise to over 2 per cent of GDP, from less than 1% in FY26

» Since the beginning of West Asia war on Feb 28, crude oil prices soared to four-year high of \$126 per barrel on Thursday, from about \$73 level before war

» He said the conflict has four channels of shock: price and supply shock, trade impact, sticky logistics costs and remittance shock

“This particular conflict, which is going to be on a low simmer or a high flame situation, whatever it is, it is going to be there with us in some form or the other because the military conflict may be over, but the strategic conflict is well and truly alive. It will be so for some time,” Nageswaran said.

He said the conflict has four channels of shock: price and supply shock, trade impact, sticky logistics costs and remittance shock.

India imports 60 per cent of its LPG usage and of that, 90 per cent flows through the now closed Strait of Hormuz.

Nageswaran said the pass-through of high global energy prices would have to be a “balancing act”. He said some pass-through is already happening in commercial LPG, and the levy of export duty on diesel and ATF.

The government has cut excise duty on petrol and diesel to shield customers from the impact of the rise in petroleum prices. “We are coming around to arriving at a certain modus vivendi with respect to burden-sharing between the fiscal policy side, inflation, households and the oil marketing companies. So it has to be a balancing act,” Nageswaran said.

TARGETS 60% LOCAL CONTENT BY 2035

Govt revises ‘Make in India’ norms for procuring HVDC substation content

NEW DELHI: The Ministry of Power has revised its “Make in India” procurement norms for the power sector, setting out a phased roadmap to achieve 60 per cent minimum local content in HVDC substations (LCC type), according to an order issued on April 30.

The move replaces the earlier uniform requirement of 60 per cent local content with a graded approach for engineering, procurement and construction (EPC) or turnkey projects.

Minimum Local Content (MLC), which indicates the proportion of domestic sourcing in a project, will now rise in stages over time.

Under the revised norms, MLC for HVDC substations will be fixed at 30 per cent

The updated roadmap applies specifically to HVDC substation projects under the EPC or turnkey category, which are crucial for long-distance power transmission

until March 31, 2028. It will increase to 40 per cent from April 1, 2028 to March 31, 2030, and further to 50 per cent from April 1, 2030 to March 31, 2032.

The target of 60 per cent will be achieved between April 1, 2032 and March 31, 2035.

DEA notifies FDI easing for foreign cos with up to 10% Chinese stake

In March, the Union Cabinet approved amendments in the press note (PN) 3 of 2020 of the DPIIT

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Finance Ministry has notified a decision to allow overseas companies with Chinese shareholding of up to 10 per cent to invest in India under the automatic route under FEMA, according to a notification.

In March, the Union Cabinet approved amendments in the press note (PN) 3 of 2020 of the DPIIT.

As per the amendments, foreign companies having a Chinese/Hong Kong shareholding of up to 10 per cent will be eligible to invest in India in sectors where foreign direct investment (FDI) is permitted under the automatic route subject to sectoral conditions.

However, these relaxed FDI rules will not apply to entities registered in China or Hong Kong or other countries sharing land borders with India.

Earlier, foreign firms with shareholders from these land border nations owning even a single share had to seek mandatory approval to invest in India in any sector.

Now, these restrictions will apply only to beneficial owners. After the Cabinet approval, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) notified it in March through a press note 2 (2026 series). The DPIIT issues FDI notifications through press



However, these relaxed FDI rules will not apply to entities registered in China or Hong Kong or other countries sharing land borders with India

notes.

According to a notification of the Department of Economic Affairs (DEA), the expression “beneficial owner” shall have the same meaning as assigned to it in clause (fa) of sub-section (1) of section 2 of the Prevention of Money-laundering Act, 2002 (15 of 2003), and shall be determined as per the criteria specified under a provision of the Prevention of Money-laundering (Maintenance of Records) Rules, 2005.

As per a PMLA rule, controlling ownership interest means ownership of or entitle-

ment to more than ten per cent of shares or capital or profits of the company.

The DEA’s notification subject is “amendment to the Foreign Exchange Management (Non debt Instruments) Rules 2019 consequent to DPIIT Press Note No 2 (2026 Series)”.

In order to curb opportunistic takeovers/acquisitions of Indian companies due to the COVID-19 pandemic, the government had amended the FDI policy through Press Note 3 (2020) on April 17, 2020.

The notification also said that a multilateral bank or fund, of which India is a member, will not be treated as an entity of a particular country, nor shall any country be treated as the beneficial owner of the investments of such bank or fund in India.

However, the investments into India from an investor entity having any direct or indirect ownership by a citizen or an entity of a country sharing land border with India; and not requiring prior government approval under the provisions of this provision, will be subject to reporting requirements specified by the Reserve Bank, it added.

China stands at the 23rd position with only 0.32 per cent share (\$2.51 billion) in the total FDI equity inflow reported in India from April 2000 to December 2025.

FinMin notifies 100% FDI in insurance sector, amends FEMA Rules

NEW DELHI: The Finance Ministry on Saturday notified 100 per cent foreign direct investment (FDI) in the insurance sector under the automatic route.

While 100 per cent foreign investment will be allowed in insurance companies and intermediaries, including brokers, under the automatic route, the cap is 20 per cent for Life Insurance Corporation (LIC), said the Foreign Exchange Management (Non-debt Instruments) (Second Amendment) Rules, 2026.

The Parliament had passed the Sabka Bima Sabki Raksha (amendment of insurance laws) Bill, 2025, in December, 2025, paving the way for hik-



ing the FDI cap in the insurance sector to 100 per cent under the automatic route, from 74 per cent earlier.

Subsequently, after the President’s assent, the Bill became law.

Thereafter in February, 2026, the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) under the Commerce & Industry Ministry had notified 100 per cent FDI in the insurance sector. PTI

TVS Motor’s total sales up 7% to 4,73,970 units in April

NEW DELHI: TVS Motor Company on Saturday reported a 7 per cent growth in total sales at 4,73,970 units in April 2026 as against 4,43,716 units in April 2025.

Total two-wheeler sales grew 6 per cent at 4,55,333 units last month against 4,30,150 units in April 2025.

Domestic two-wheeler sales up 8 per cent to 3,48,545 units in April 2026 against 3,23,647 units in April 2025. Motorcycle sales in April 2026 fell to 2,00,039 units against 2,20,347 units in April 2025, while scooter sales rose 24 per cent to 2,11,158 units against 1,69,741 units. EVs saw 36 per cent increase at 37,771 units against 27,684 units in April 2025.

Three-wheeler sales were up 37 per cent at 18,637 units in April 2026 against 13,566 units in April 2025.

International sales clocked a 3 per cent rise at 1,20,008 units in April 2026 as against 1,16,700 units in the same month last year. PTI

CDSL posts ₹455 crore profit for FY26, consolidated income at ₹1,239 crore

MUMBAI: Central Depository Services (India) Ltd on Saturday said its consolidated net profit stood at Rs 80 crore in the March quarter of 2025-26 financial year against Rs 100 crore in the year-ago period.

Total income during the quarter was Rs 268 crore as against Rs 256 crore in the same quarter of FY25, a company statement said.

For the full 2025-26 fiscal, net profit was Rs 455 crore against Rs 526 crore in the previous 2024-25 financial year.

Total consolidated income rose to Rs 1,239 crore in FY26 against Rs 1,199 crore in FY25, CDSL said.

The company said that it became the first depository to register 18 crore-plus demat accounts as of March 31, 2026,

extending the trajectory from 15.30 crore accounts as of March 31, 2025.

Nehal Vora, Managing Director & Chief Executive Officer, said, “financial year 2025-26 stands as a defining year in our journey of empowering India’s Atmanirbhar Investors.

“Surpassing 18 crore demat accounts reflects not merely scale, but the deepening trust of Indian households in the securities market, and with under 10 per cent of India’s population participating today, the runway ahead remains substantial.”

The Board of Directors has recommended a final dividend of Rs 12.75 per equity share of the face value of Rs 10 per share for 2025-26, CDSL said. PTI

MCF, Raebareli rolls out its first 16-car Vande Bharat Chair Car trainset

RAEBARELI: India’s Vande Bharat programme is nearing a major milestone, with its 100th trainset on the horizon since the rollout began in 2018 with just two trains.

Marking a key development, the Modern Coach Factory (MCF) in Raebareli has rolled out its first 16-car Vande Bharat Chair Car trainset, joining the network of manufacturers. The

new rake is equipped with an advanced Siemens propulsion system and will undergo oscillation trials to assess ride quality, safety and performance before entering passenger service.

The train retains the Vande Bharat focus on speed, efficiency and passenger comfort, while incorporating several upgrades to enhance reliability and safety. Features include ergonomic

seating, jerk-free travel, sealed gangways and automatic plug doors for reduced noise.

Safety systems include the indigenous ‘Kavach’ Automatic Train Protection technology,

advanced fire detection with aerosol-based suppression, and flood protection for critical equipment. The use of vacuum infusion technology has also improved interior finish

and durability. Designed with inclusivity in mind, the train is Divyangjan-friendly, offering ramps, dedicated spaces and accessibility features for passengers with disabilities. MPOST

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ़ इंडिया
Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए 'केन्द्रित' "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

DEMAND NOTICE 13(2) OF SECURITISATION ACT 2002

LADO SARAI BRANCH, F-344/1, TARA BHAWAN, NEAR QUTAB MINAR, OLD M.B. ROAD, LADO SARAI, NEW DELHI-110030

Demand Notice Under Section 13(2) of the Securitization and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest (SARFAESI) Act, 2002 to the Borrower/s and Guarantor/s.
This Demand Notice is hereby given under section 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 (54 of 2002) read with rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 hereinafter calling upon the under mentioned Borrowers / Guarantors to repay, the Amounts outstanding for the Credit Facilities granted to them / on their Guarantee, within 60 days from the date of this Notice. If you fail to repay to the Bank the below mentioned amount with further interest and incidental expenses, costs etc. in terms of this notice u/s 13(2) of the Act, the Bank will exercise all or any of the rights detailed under Sub-Section (4) of Section 13 and under other applicable provisions of the said Act. You are also put on notice that in terms of sub-section 4 of Section 13 you shall not transfer by sale, lease or otherwise the said secured assets detailed below of this notice without obtaining written consent of the Bank. **The details of the account and Secured Assets along with Amount Outstanding is given below:-**
SCHEDULE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY & OTHER DETAILS

Name & Address of Borrower and Guarantor	Description of the Secured Asset	Date & Amount of 13(2) Notice
BORROWER: MR. NIKHIL TIWARI S/O SH. RAM SHARAN TIWARI Address 1: Flat No.M-601, Aura Chimera, Raj Nagar Extension, Distt.- Ghaziabad, U.P.-201017. Address 2: Property Bearing No. RZ-F1/136A, Upper Ground Floor without Roof Rights, Khasra No.88/3 situated in the revenue estate of Village Palam, Delhi State Delhi Colony known as Mahavir Enclave New Delhi-110045 in the name of Mr. Nikhil Tiwari S/o Sh. Ram Sharan Tiwari. Boundries are: East: Property No.RZ-F-1/136B West: Property No.RZ-F-1/135 North: Other's Property South: Road 20 Ft.	(Detailed description of the secured Asset/Mortgaged Property/ Hypothecated Goods) IMMOVABLE ASSET: Property Bearing No. RZ-F1/136A, Uppr Ground Floor without Roof Rights, Area Measuring 78 Sq.Yds. i.e. 65.2158 Sq.Mtr. out of Khasra No.88/3 situated in the revenue estate of Village Palam, Delhi State Delhi Colony known as Mahavir Enclave New Delhi-110045 in the name of Mr. Nikhil Tiwari S/o Sh. Ram Sharan Tiwari. Boundries are: East: Property No.RZ-F-1/136B West: Property No.RZ-F-1/135 North: Other's Property South: Road 20 Ft.	Date of 13(2) Notice: 22/04/2026 NPA : 20/04/2026 Rs.47,78,084.82 (Rupees Forty Seven Lakh Seventy Eight Thousand Eighty Four and Eighty Two Paise Only) with further interest at the applicable rate/s of interest mentioned in the Schedule A from the date of notice 22/04/2026 till the date of full and final payment along with incidental expenses, charges and costs recoverable from you as per terms of contract and/or as per law, within sixty days from the date of this notice.

YOUR ATTENTION IS DRAWN TO THE PROVISIONS OF SECTION 13(8) OF THE SARFAESI ACT, 2002 IN RESPECT OF TIME AVAILABLE TO YOU TO REDEEM THE SECURED ASSETS.
DATE: 02.05.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Sd/- Authorised Officer,
Central Bank of India

सेन्ट्रल बैंक ऑफ़ इंडिया
Central Bank of India
1911 से आपके लिए 'केन्द्रित' "CENTRAL" TO YOU SINCE 1911

DEMAND NOTICE 13(2) OF SECURITISATION ACT 2002

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SCHEDULE OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY & OTHER DETAILS

Name & Address of Borrower and Guarantor	Description of the Secured Asset	Date & Amount of 13(2) Notice
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DATE: 02.05.2026
PLACE: NEW DELHI

Sd/- Authorised Officer,
Central Bank of India

Kotak Mahindra Bank March qtr net profit up 10% at ₹5,423 crore

MUMBAI: Kotak Mahindra Bank on Saturday reported 10 per cent rise in consolidated net profit at Rs 5,423 crore for the fourth quarter of financial year 2025-26.

In the year-ago period, the profit stood at Rs 4,933 crore.

On a standalone basis, it reported a 13 per cent year-on-year rise in net profit at Rs 4,027 crore. Core net interest income of the bank increased 8 per cent to Rs 7,876 crore from Rs 7,284 crore a year ago.

Net interest margin improved to 4.67 per cent from 4.54 per cent in December quarter. However, it fell on a yearly basis, from 4.97 per cent in Q4FY25.

Net advances increased 16 per cent year-on-year to Rs 4.96 lakh crore as on March 31, 2026.

Customer Assets which comprise advances (including IBPC & BRDS) and credit substitutes grew to Rs 5.46 lakh crore as at March-end



On a standalone basis, it reported a 13% year-on-year rise in net profit at Rs 4,027 cr

2026 from Rs 4.78 lakh crore a year ago.

Total period-end deposits grew 15 per cent year-on-year to Rs 5.73 lakh crore in Q4FY26. Average total deposit too rose 15 per cent to Rs 5.38 lakh crore. Average current deposit was higher by 18 per cent at Rs 77,058 crore during the quarter. PTI

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Delhi State Legal Services Authority
in Coordination With
Delhi Traffic Police
is organising

National Lok Adalat

at seven Court Complexes on **09.05.2026**

— Court Complexes —

Patiala House

Karkardooma

Tis Hazari

Saket

Rohini

Dwarka

Rouse Avenue

- Only compoundable Traffic **challans/notices** pending on Delhi Traffic Police Portal and forwarded to Virtual Court till **31.01.2026** will be taken up in this Lok Adalat.
- All the **Notices/Challans** are to be downloaded from Delhi Traffic Police Website i.e <https://traffic.delhipolice.gov.in/lokadalat> or by scanning the QR Code.
- It is mandatory to **carry a print out** of the **Notices/Challans**, as no printing facility will be available at the court complexes.

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Balasubramaniam, Aniya appointed as full-time members of NITI Aayog

On April 24, govt appointed Ashok Kumar Lahiri as its vice-chairman

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: The Centre on Saturday appointed academican Joram Aniya and scholar-author R Balasubramaniam as full-time members of the Niti Aayog, taking the total number of such members in the government think tank to seven, along with a vice-chairman. Prime Minister Narendra Modi is the chairman of the Niti Aayog.

“In continuation of the Cabinet Secretariat’s notification dated 24.04.2026, the prime minister has approved the appointment of the following persons as full-time members of the NITI Aayog with effect from the date of assumption of charge and until further orders, on the same terms and conditions as are applicable to full-time members: (i) Dr R Balasubramaniam; (ii) Dr Joram Aniya,” a notification issued by



the Cabinet Secretariat said.

On April 24, while reconstituting the Niti Aayog, the government appointed Ashok Kumar Lahiri as its vice-chairman and economist K V Raju, AIIMS Director M Srinivas, Secretary in the Department of Science and Technology, Abhay Karandikar, scientist Gobardhan Das and former Cabinet secretary Rajiv Gauba as full-time members.

Wishing the new appointees, Prime Minister Modi said in a post on X, “Congratulations to Dr R. Balasubramaniam Ji and Dr Joram Aniya Ji on being appointed as full-time members of NITI Aayog. Their rich experience and deep understanding of various issues will greatly strengthen policy making.

“I am confident their contributions will help drive innovation and growth across sectors.

Highlights

- » Aniya has more than 18 years of experience in teaching, research, and public policy engagement
- » Scholar-author Balasubramaniam is a public policy expert and development activist

Wishing them a very productive and impactful tenure ahead.”

Sources said Aniya’s inclusion in the government think tank marked a historic moment, bringing an eminent intellectual voice from Arunachal Pradesh to the highest level of national policymaking.

An accomplished academician, associate professor, and member of the Arunachal Pradesh Private Educational

Regulatory Commission, Aniya has more than 18 years of experience in teaching, research, and public policy engagement.

Notably, she is the first woman from the Nyishi community to earn a PhD, and the first in Hindi language in the state, with significant contributions to literature, culture and indigenous knowledge systems. She has authored and edited many books on Nyishi literature and culture, along with numerous research publications.

Scholar-author Balasubramaniam is a public policy expert and development activist. A qualified physician, he is the founder of Swami Vivekananda Youth Movement (SVYM) & Grassroots Research & Advocacy Movement (GRAM). Balasubramaniam has a master’s degree in public administration from the Harvard Kennedy School, Harvard University.

‘Op Sindoor reflected India’s resolve to eliminate terrorism’

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Saturday described Operation Sindoor as a reflection of the Modi government’s “unwavering resolve” to eliminate terrorism through “decisive action”.

Singh also said the “unmatched valour” of the armed forces during the operation has marked it as a “golden chapter” in India’s military history. The defence minister made the remarks while addressing an event named “Shaurya” organised in New Delhi in the run-up to the first anniversary of Operation Sindoor.

India launched Operation Sindoor on May 7 last year in response to the April 22 Pahalgam terror attack. The operation targeted terror infrastructure in territories controlled by Pakistan. The strikes triggered four days of intense clashes that ended with an understanding on stopping the military actions on May 10.

In his remarks, Singh commended the valour, dedication and patriotism of the soldiers,



Defence Minister Rajnath Singh

The ‘unmatched valour’ of armed forces during the operation has marked it as a ‘golden chapter’ in India’s military history, he said

and said their ethos of “nation first and service before self” have defined India’s military traditions from ancient times to contemporary operations, such as Operation Sindoor, according to the defence ministry.

The valour of the defence forces extends beyond the battlefield as they provide

humanitarian assistance as first responders during natural disasters within the country and abroad, Singh said.

“Our soldiers use weapons to protect their people, and deliver food and medicines to those in need during the times of crises. This is the defining characteristic of our defence forces,” he said.

Chief of Defence Staff General Anil Chauhan, Chief of the Air Staff Air Chief Marshal A P Singh, Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, Defence Secretary Rajesh Kumar Singh and Vice Chief of the Army Staff Lieutenant General Dhiraj Seth attended the event. The event was a confluence of art and valour, with top defence officials, hundreds of military personnel and noted artists joining it.

Singh highlighted that valour and art are often viewed as opposites, but they, in fact, complement each other. The defence minister underlined that the marching songs by military bands unify soldiers, with music transforming individual identity into collective strength.

From Page 1

Pay Iran...

from leaving and depriving Tehran of oil revenue it needs to shore up its ailing economy.

The US Central Command has said 45 commercial ships have been told to turn around since the blockade began. US President Donald Trump said that the US Navy is acting like “pirates” in waters and boasted about how operations take place while seizing ships amid the blockade of Iranian ports. “We ... land on top of it and we took over the ship. We took over the cargo, took over the oil. It’s a very profitable business,” Trump said on Saturday while addressing a rally in Florida.

As the crowd cheered, he said, “We’re like pirates. We’re sort of like pirates. But we’re not playing games.” President Trump has rejected Iran’s latest proposal to end the war.

“They want to make a deal, I’m not satisfied with it, so we’ll see what happens,” Trump said Friday. He didn’t elaborate but expressed frustration with Iran’s leadership, calling it “very disjointed”. Iran’s state-run IRNA news agency said Tehran handed over its plan to mediators in Pakistan on Thursday night.

The shaky three-week ceasefire between the US and Iran appears to be holding, though both countries have traded accusations of violations. Negotiations continued by phone after Trump called off his envoys’ trip to Pakistan last weekend, the president said. Trump this week floated a new plan to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

A senior Iranian military officer on Saturday said that it was “likely” that the war with the United States could resume after President Trump said he was not satisfied with an Iranian negotiating proposal.

According to Iran’s Fars News, Mohammad Jafar Asadi, a senior figure in the Iranian military’s central command, said, “a renewed conflict between Iran and the United States is likely.” He told the publication that the recent actions and statements of US officials only aimed at “extricating themselves from the mess they have created”.

“The actions and statements of US officials are primarily media-driven, aimed first at preventing a drop in oil prices and second at extricating themselves from the mess they have created,” he said. Asadi added that Iran’s armed forces are “fully prepared” if the US plans for an escalation. “The armed forces are fully prepared for any new adventures or foolishness from the Americans,” he said.

Meanwhile, reports said that imprisoned Nobel Prize laureate Narges Mohammadi remained hospitalized in Zanjan in northwestern Iran after being transferred there from prison late Friday. Her foundation described the condition of the rights lawyer as “very high risk”, with fluctuating blood pressure and severe nausea.

Iran on Saturday said it hanged two men convicted of spying for Israel.

The Iranian judiciary’s news outlet, Mizanonline, identified the men as Yaghoub Karimpour and Nasser Bekrzadeh. It said they were hanged after the Supreme Court upheld death sentences

Mamata tells...

would be awarded. To stop any kind of irregularities during counting, TMC has announced the names of representatives who will be dedicated to the districts. “Such exit polls have no value. The 2021 and 2024 exit polls were way off the mark. I think most such polls are meant to influence the share market,” she added.

She also said that in case of any TMC candidate losing a seat by “a margin of 200-300 votes”, the counting agents must insist on a recount.

“TMC will stand beside counting agents who had been allegedly assaulted by Central Forces during voting or campaigning,” she assured. Incidentally, the Anit Thapa-led Bharatiya Gorkha Prajatantrik Morcha (BGPM) contested the remaining three seats in the Darjeeling hills.

Mamata has also urged the counting agents not to take outside food. She also urged these agents not to pay any heed to propaganda spread on television that “they (BJP) were winning”. She also warned to remain careful while uploading data. Abhishek Banerjee, who also interacted

with the counting agents virtually, asked them to insist on recounting, particularly for postal ballots, in case of defeat of TMC nominees by a narrow margin.

“All unusual activities inside counting centres, like the sudden power outage at the Nandigram counting centre in 2021, must be immediately reported to the party’s top brass,” he said. Abhishek also urged the party’s students’ wing to remain posted at electric transformers, especially in East Midnapore. He also asked counting agents not to leave the counting stations till they obtain certificates.

Abhishek also instructed the counting agents to compare Form 17 C with the party’s serial number after the EVMs arrive. If the number of batches does not match, the EVMs cannot be opened. If the numbers match, seal, date and time should also be checked, he added.

The virtual meeting began at 4 pm and lasted for nearly two hours. Saturday’s meeting covered key aspects of the counting process, including the number of rounds and protocols to be followed once the electronic voting machines (EVMs) are brought out of strong rooms and unsealed.

Despite expressing her confidence of a “landslide victory”, Mamata Banerjee has repeatedly aired her apprehensions of “counting malpractice and EVM tampering ahead of the day of results”.

Abhishek will look after South 24-Parganas, while Sougata Roy and Partha Bhowmik have been given charges of North 24-Parganas, Rathin Ghosh for Barasat organisational district, Sudip Bandopadhyay, Kunal Ghosh, Vivek Gupta, Swapan Samaddar for Kolkata North, Aroop Biswas and Firhad Hakim for Kolkata South.

The TMC appointed Rajya Sabha MP Rajeev Kumar as counting observer for the Barrackpore-Dum Dum organisational district ahead of the West Bengal Assembly election results on May 4.

Meanwhile, TMC leader Kunal Ghosh on Saturday claimed that the BJP would not win more than 78 seats in the West Bengal elections.

Speaking to reporters here, Ghosh said he has “information from credible sources that front-ranking leaders of some political parties confided at a recent meeting that the BJP will not get more than 78 seats in the polls.”

Falta seat to go...

at Magrahat West and 4 booths at Diamond Harbour following scrutiny in the wake of allegations of EVM tampering.

As per reports by the Commission, the overall voting percentage available from 14 of the 15 booths till 5 pm was 86.90, with Diamond Harbour registering 87.60 per cent and Magrahat Paschim 86.11 per cent.

According to ground-level reports, a good number of migrant workers who had come for voting on Wednesday could not cast their franchise during the repoll, as they had to return for work.

The poll percentage would have increased further if they had been able to vote.

While the re-poll was held peacefully, tension escalated in Hashimnagar and adjoining areas in Falta from the morning, amidst allegations of local Trinamool Congress intimidating BJP supporters and asking them to leave the area. In protest, National Highway 17 was blocked with villagers demanding the arrest of those allegedly involved and immediate re-poll.

Police observer Ajay Pal Sharma reached the spot along with the police and the Central Forces to bring the situation under control.

Following reports from the field level, the Election Commission issued orders for the arrest of Israfil Chakdar and Sujauddin Sheikh, who are known to be close associates of Falta’s TMC candidate Jahangir Khan, by Saturday and also sought a detailed report of the incident.

Falta has been in the spotlight since the second phase of polling, with allegations of EVM tampering. Complaints included the use of tape on EVM units to cover BJP symbols, along with reports of CCTV cameras being deliberately switched off during voting on Wednesday.

According to sources in the poll body, Special Observer Subrata Gupta, who conducted a field review on Thursday under the instructions of the apex poll body, had recommended re-polling in around 30 booths in Falta.

Sources in the Commission said scrutiny revealed serious irregularities in several booths, including disruptions in CCTV surveillance and alleged attempts to influence voting. In some

cases, presiding officers reportedly removed tape from EVMs only after a significant percentage of votes had already been cast.

“The recommendations of the special observer regarding re-polling, along with related reports and documents, have already been sent to the Election Commission of India. The ECI will take the call about repolling,” Bengal Chief Electoral Officer Manoj Agarwal had stated earlier in the day.

Pathak in FIR...

Trident Limited on April 30. Rajya Sabha MP Rajinder Gupta is the chairman emeritus of the company. Gupta was also one of the seven MPs who quit the AAP and joined the BJP last month. Earlier, the Punjab Police had withdrawn the security cover of MP and former cricketer Harbhajan Singh.

On April 24, the AAP suffered a jolt when seven of its 10 Rajya Sabha MPs quit the party, alleging that the Kejriwal-led outfit has strayed from its principles, values and core morals.

Besides Pathak, Gupta and Singh, the others who quit the party were Raghav Chadha, Ashok Mittal, Vikramjit Sahney and Swati Maliwal. Six of them were from Punjab.

Rajya Sabha Chairman C P Radhakrishnan later officially accepted their merger with the BJP, reducing the AAP’s strength in the Upper House of Parliament to three.

Meanwhile, Punjab BJP leaders accused the AAP government in Punjab of indulging in “political vendetta”.

In a post on X, Punjab BJP president Sunil Jakhar accused the AAP of double standards and said, “Those whom your leader was calling the apple of his eye just a few days ago, today, as soon as they switch parties, flaws start appearing in them. Isn’t this proof of Aam Aadmi Party’s double standards?”

Talking to reporters, Jakhar said the BJP is not intimidated by the FIRs filed by the Punjab Police, claiming that these actions are meant to divert attention from Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann’s alleged conduct of arriving in the Assembly in an inebriated state on Friday, a charge vehemently denied by the ruling party.

Reiterating that the BJP stands firmly by its leaders, Jakhar said the party will oppose any form of “political vendetta”. He also cautioned officials against overstepping legal boundaries while carrying out such actions.

Asked about the FIRs, Jakhar said he does not have complete details. “I have learnt that one is regarding giving a threat to someone and another is about corruption charges,” he said.

Punjab BJP’s working president Ashwani Sharma also called the FIRs against Pathak “political vendetta”.

“The registration of a non-bailable FIR against Rajya Sabha MP Sandeep Pathak in Punjab after he left the AAP and joined the BJP clearly shows that police are being used as a political weapon by Kejriwal and Mann,” Sharma alleged in a post in Punjabi on X.

“This is not just a case: This is the politics of fear, panic and revenge,” he added.

Senior Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) leader Bikram Singh Majithia slammed the AAP for “selectively targeting” those who fell out with it.

“Sandeep Pathak was once a trusted aide of @BhagwantMann and @ArvindKejriwal, a key power centre. If he was wrong then, he was following his bosses Arvind Kejriwal and Bhagwant Mann. Then who was in collusion with him, and why are they not being booked now?” asked Majithia.

The BJP also alleged that the law-and-order scenario in Punjab has deteriorated.

The saffron party’s national spokesperson, Sudhanshu Trivedi, claimed that the police action reflects misplaced priorities. “The Punjab Police went to Pathak’s residence and attempted to carry out a raid. We want to ask whether the law-and-order situation has become so weak that police are unable to act against drug traffickers, but are being used in this manner?” he asked while talking to reporters.

WITH AGENCY INPUTS

Defuse turns fatal...

personnel from the Bastar Fighters and the district force, he said.

During the operation, the team first detected

a Maoist dump and recovered materials belonging to the ultras. Around 11.30 am, they found another dump containing an IED concealed beneath the ground, he said.

However, the explosive went off while personnel were attempting to retrieve it for defusing it, critically injuring four personnel, the official said.

Inspector Sukhram Vatti (40) of the DRG, who was leading the team, constable Krishna Komra (35) of the district force, and constable Sanjay Gadhpal (29) of the Bastar Fighters succumbed to their injuries on the spot.

Another injured constable, Parmanand Komra (29) of the Bastar Fighters, was airlifted to Raipur but died during treatment at a hospital there, he added.

While Inspector Vatti was a resident of Bijapur district, the three other personnel hailed from Kanker district.

A Bomb Disposal Squad (BDS) was also present at the site. Prima facie, it appears that the IED may have exploded due to an accidental circuit connection while being retrieved, the official said, adding that a detailed ballistic and forensic examination is underway to ascertain the exact cause of the blast.

Security forces have launched a search operation in the area, he said.

Chhattisgarh Deputy Chief Minister Vijay Sharma termed the incident as “very tragic” and said the entire government stands firmly with the families of the martyred police personnel.

Based on the intelligence inputs, security personnel went to recover a Maoist dump and successfully located it containing explosives, he said. “They handled the device according to standard procedure, but the nature of its manufacturing was such that it triggered a powerful explosion, in which four personnel were martyred. This is a very tragic incident,” he told reporters in Nava Raipur.

Pune: 4-yr-old...

a private residence which captured him with the child. A case was registered against him under relevant provisions of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita and Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act.

He was later produced before the sessions court in Pune which remanded him in police custody till May 7.

Members of Maratha organisations tried to block the police vehicle carrying the accused on the court premises.

The incident triggered massive outrage in Bhor area, with hundreds of villagers rushing to the local police outpost and demanding action against the accused. They also staged a blockade on the Mumbai-Bengaluru Highway.

Pune (Rural) Superintendent of Police Sandip Singh Gill assured the villagers that a charge sheet will be filed in the case within 15 days and the trial will be expedited.

“The accused has criminal history, with cases registered against him in 1998 and 2015. He was acquitted in both cases. He is a labourer and typically wanders around the village and occasionally takes up jobs,” he told reporters.

Maharashtra Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis, who also heads the home department, said the incident was “extremely shameful and deeply painful” and promised a fast-track court trial.

“We will request the High Court to appoint a special public prosecutor. Efforts will be made to ensure capital punishment for the accused in the shortest possible time,” he said, while also stating that politicisation of the incident is insensitive.

Fadnavis also expressed condolences for the deceased child’s family and said the government stands with them in this difficult time.

Termining the incident “extremely outrageous”, NCP (SP) leader and former state home minister Anil Deshmukh demanded death sentence for the accused.

“How do such criminals roam freely in society? When I was home minister in the Maha Vikas Aghadi government, we brought in the Shakti Act (which provided for stringent punishment for crimes against women), which is pending final nod from the Central Government. When there is an urgent need for this law, the Centre and state government are passing the buck to each other instead of implementing it,” said Deshmukh.

“Had this strong law been in force, this monster (accused) would have received death penalty

within 15 days,” he said.

Fadnavis had earlier said that the Shakti Bill was passed by the state legislature in 2020 and sent to the Centre for the President’s assent, but the President sent it back.

NCP (SP) leaders Supriya Sule and Rohit Pawar visited the deceased girl’s village. Sule, in whose Baramati Lok Sabha constituency the village falls, said she would meet Fadnavis on Tuesday and seek stringent action against the accused.

“How did this accused get bail in past criminal cases? There should be a fast-track trial in the case,” said the MP while also ruing that the state women’s commission does not have a chairperson at present.

AGENCIES

Govt appoints...

Jain is currently Executive Director at the Reserve Bank of India (RBI).

According to the RBI Act, 1934, the central bank should have four deputy governors,” two from within the ranks, one commercial banker and an economist to head the monetary policy department.

The other three deputy governors are Swaminathan J, Poonam Gupta and S C Murmu.

Rabi Sankar was first appointed Deputy Governor in September 2021 for three years and was given a one-year extension in 2024 and subsequently in 2025.

Implement circular...

clarifications, the Special Leave Petition stands dismissed,” it added.

Senior Advocate Dama Seshadri Naidu appeared for ECI and contended that the returning officer has overarching power, and he is from the state government cadre. “Each candidate will also have their own counting agent. It is a completely misplaced apprehension,” he urged.

Calling the observation a “tight slap” on the BJP and the ECI, TMC spokesperson and Belegghata Candidate Kunal Ghosh alleged that an additional Chief Electoral Officer in Bengal had issued a communication, allegedly to “appease” the BJP, stating that only central government employees would be deployed as counting supervisors and assistants. He said after TMC challenged the communication, the apex court emphasised “random selection of both state and central government employees”.

Senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the TMC, criticised sections of the media for “misreporting” the court’s observation. “The mainstream media is reporting that our petition was dismissed, which is entirely wrong... At least provide accurate information,” he said, alleging bias in coverage.

Sibal explained that the ECI had decided to appoint a central government nominee at every booth, alongside existing micro-observers, polling agents and supervisors. He noted that when the matter was heard in the High Court, the circular was upheld. Before the Supreme Court, however, the TMC chose not to challenge the circular but sought its proper implementation.

Referring to the April 13 circular, Sibal said it acknowledged reports of irregularities and provided for the presence of central government employees in addition to micro-observers. He pointed out the circular also mandated a system for randomisation of counting personnel through ECI NET, drawing from both state and central government databases.

“The key point is the random selection of state and central government employees... This means both can be appointed for counting duties,” he said.

According to the TMC, the Supreme Court clarified that Clause 1 of the April 13 communication must be read alongside its provision for random selection, thereby ensuring the inclusion of both state and central government personnel in counting roles.

Earlier, the Calcutta High Court upheld the Election Commission’s decision to appoint central government and PSU employees as counting supervisors for the West Bengal Assembly elections, rejecting TMC’s challenge as based on mere apprehension without evidence. The court ruled that election rules allow both state and central officials, affirming the Commission’s discretion and the Chief Electoral Officer’s authority.

SEARCH UNDERWAY FOR TWO TOURISTS

MP boat tragedy: Death toll rises to 11



Rescue operation underway after a cruise boat carrying 29 passengers overturned in the Bargi dam reservoir due to a sudden storm, in Jabalpur district, Madhya Pradesh, Saturday

MPOST BUREAU

JABALPUR: The bodies of two boys were recovered on Saturday evening from the Bargi Dam in Jabalpur district of Madhya Pradesh, raising the death toll in the cruise boat tragedy that occurred two days ago to 11, while search continued for two missing persons.

The boat, operated by the state tourism department, capsized during a storm on Thursday evening with some of the survivors alleging negligence and safety lapses such as life jackets not being distributed in time.

The bodies of Viraj Soni (6) and Tamil (5) were recovered on Saturday, said Sub-Divisional Officer of Police (SDOP) Anjul Ayank Mishra.

Tamil's father Kamraj, an employee of the Ordnance Factory at Khamaria, and Kamraj's nephew Mayuram (5) were still missing, he added.

Divers and disaster response teams have expanded

HIGHLIGHTS

- » The boat, operated by the state tourism department, capsized during a storm on Thursday evening
- » Some of the survivors alleged negligence and safety lapses such as life jackets not being distributed in time
- » Divers and disaster response teams have expanded the search radius to five km
- » Of the 41 identified passengers on board the ill-fated vessel, 28 were rescued

the search radius to five km, the police official said. Of the 41 identified passengers on board the ill-fated vessel, 28 were rescued, police said.

More than 200 rescuers,

including around 20 Army divers airlifted from Agra, joined the search operation that resumed at 5 on Saturday morning. The operation, involving the National Disaster Response Force, State Disaster Response Force and local divers, was briefly affected at around 9 am due to strong winds, officials said.

Post-mortem examinations of nine deceased persons have been completed, Mishra said.

“Our priority is to search for the missing persons. We will also register a First Information Report in the case soon,” he said.

Police said CCTV footage near the boarding point showed 43 people heading towards the boat while the identities of 41 passengers have been confirmed so far.

The state government on Friday ordered a probe into the tragedy and dismissed three crew members. It also banned the operation of similar vessels in the state.

Andhra liquor ‘scam’: ED officer accused of torture & extortion; HC seeks interrogation rooms’ footage

OUR CORRESPONDENT

HYDERABAD: The probe by the Enforcement Directorate into the alleged Rs 4,000-crore Andhra Pradesh liquor scam has been overshadowed by serious allegations of extortion, physical assault and mental harassment against one of its investigating officers, even as the agency intensifies its crackdown on the suspected syndicate.

The controversy centres on Assistant Director Prateek Singh of the ED's Hyderabad zonal office. A writ petition filed before the Telangana High Court by Kiran G.S., who was summoned in connection with the case, has accused the officer and others of resorting to coercive tactics, including “third-degree” treatment, threats and attempts to extract money. The



petitioner has sought disciplinary and departmental action against the officials concerned, alleging gross abuse of power and manipulation of the criminal justice process.

Significantly, the plea also calls for the preservation and production of CCTV footage—both audio and video—from the Hyderabad zonal

INSIGHT

- » The controversy centres on Assistant Director Prateek Singh of the ED's Hyderabad office
- » A writ petition filed before the Telangana High Court by Kiran G.S., who was summoned in connection with the case, has accused the officer and others of resorting to coercive tactics, including ‘third-degree’ treatment, threats and attempts to extract money
- » The petitioner sought disciplinary & departmental action against the officials concerned, alleging gross abuse of power and manipulation of criminal justice process

office, including interrogation rooms and common areas, to substantiate the allegations. Acting on the petition, the High Court, in an order dated April 29, directed the ED to produce footage from April 20 by May 1.

According to the ED, the alleged scam took shape after 2019, when the state govern-

ment replaced a transparent, automated liquor distribution system with a manual regime under the Andhra Pradesh State Beverages Corporation Limited. This shift allegedly enabled discretionary allocation of Orders for Supply, allowing officials to favour select liquor brands in exchange for kickbacks while

sidelining established players.

The agency has further alleged that distilleries were coerced into paying illegal commissions ranging from 15 to 20 per cent per case to secure supply approvals. Communications related to these transactions were allegedly conducted through encrypted platforms to evade detection.

Investigators have also pointed to the use of “similar-sounding brands” with inflated pricing to generate surplus margins that could be diverted as illegal payments.

As part of the probe, the ED conducted searches across Hyderabad and Tirupati on April 24, targeting individuals believed to be linked to the previous YSR Congress Party regime, including associates of former chief minister Y. S. Jagan Mohan Reddy.

No need to panic over May heat, says Centre

OUR CORRESPONDENT

NEW DELHI: Union Minister Jitendra Singh on Saturday played down concerns over the expected heat in May, saying there is no need for panic if people follow basic precautions and official advisories. He urged citizens to rely on updates from the India Meteorological Department.

Citing the IMD's outlook, the minister said the second and fourth weeks of May could see a rise in temperatures across northwestern, central and western India, as well as parts of the east coast. The first and third weeks, however, are likely to bring some relief with rainfall and thunderstorms linked to western disturbances.

The extended forecast indicates above-normal maximum temperatures in southern peninsular India and parts of the northeast and northwest, while

many other regions may record normal to below-normal temperatures. Heatwave conditions are expected in pockets such as the Himalayan foothills, Odisha, coastal Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu, Gujarat and Maharashtra, with two to four additional heatwave days likely.

Singh said the government is working with states and districts to ensure drinking water availability, cooling arrangements and uninterrupted power supply, with special focus on vulnerable groups including children, the elderly and outdoor workers. On agriculture, he said conditions remain favourable for late Rabi harvest in northern India, though parts of the south and northeast could face localised heat stress affecting crops like Boro rice, maize and pulses. Farmers have been advised to work during cooler hours and maintain proper irrigation.

Govt strengthening spiritual values along with development: Hry CM

REWARI: Chief Minister Nayab Singh Saini on Saturday said Haryana is the land of saints and warriors, where service, sacrifice and 'dharma' hold a special place in its culture. In line with this rich heritage, the Haryana government is continuously working not only for economic development, but also to strengthen the cultural and spiritual values of the state, he said.

He said the government is running several programmes, including facilitating pilgrimages to holy places for the people of the state, to promote cultural and spiritual values.

Saini was attending a programme at Gokalpur Shiv Temple Ashram in Rewari, according to an official release. The ancient temple, believed to have been built during the Mahabharata period, stands as a witness to our glorious past, he said. Appreciating the three-day



Maharudra Yagya and the grand 'bhandara' being organised at the Ashram, he described it as a symbol of social unity, service, and dedication.

Saini also praised the work being carried out by Swami Dheeraj Giri Maharaj, including the operation of an animal hospital, service to cows, marriages of poor and destitute women, and educational support for underprivileged children. When the BJP government came to power in Haryana in 2014, the budget for cow welfare was only Rs 2 crore, which has now been increased

to Rs 600 crore. He said continuous financial assistance is being provided to 'gaushalas' and 'nandishalas' for the protection of cattle.

He requested Swami Dheeraj Giri Maharaj to get the 'gaushala' run by the Ashram registered, so that it can receive government assistance.

Meanwhile, during his visit to Rewari, Saini reached a protest site near village Ramgarh Bhagwanpur on NH-71 and brought it to an end. The protest had been continuing since June 17, 2025.

Interacting directly with the protesting residents, the CM assured them that a 200-bed modern hospital and an ayurvedic college would be established near the village, subject to the availability of suitable land. He also assured the construction of a modern sports stadium and a waterworks facility in the village.

India, Nepal draft roadmap for flood control

MPOST BUREAU

KATHMANDU: India and Nepal have drafted a roadmap for collaboration in areas of flood control and irrigation, as senior officials of the two sides met here and comprehensively reviewed bilateral water-sector cooperation. The discussion took place at the two-day 11th meeting of the India-Nepal Joint Committee on Kosi and Gandak Projects, which concluded in Kathmandu on Friday.

The Indian delegation was led by Santosh Kumar Mall, Principal Secretary, Water Resources Department, Government of Bihar, and the Nepalese delegation was led by Mitra Baral, Director General, Department of Irrigation, according to a press release issued by the Indian Embassy.

CM urges Punjab youth to start their ventures, assures support

CHANDIGARH: Punjab Chief Minister Bhagwant Mann on Saturday urged the state's youth to transition from job seekers to job creators, asserting that his government is building a robust ecosystem to support entrepreneurship and reduce the need for migration abroad.

Addressing a Lok Milni in Mohali's Saneta village, Mann said opportunities are being generated within Punjab, enabling young people to start their own ventures with full state backing. He contrasted his administration's performance with previous regimes led by the Shiromani Akali Dal and the Congress, accusing them of citing empty coffers while failing to deliver. “The system was never the limitation, but the lack of political will,” he said.



The Chief Minister also hit back at opposition criticism, alleging that rivals were making “false and baseless” personal allegations out of frustration over the government's work. “I may not have experience in looting public wealth, but I understand people's problems and how to solve them,” he said, adding that such attacks would not deter him from pursuing development.

Mann announced that he

would meet the President on May 5 to press for a stringent law against political defections, calling the practice a “betrayal of public mandate.” He said opportunistic leaders switching parties for personal gain undermined democracy and must be checked through stricter legislation.

Highlighting governance priorities, Mann said the state has focused on improving education, healthcare and power supply. He stressed that education is the key to eliminating poverty and criticised earlier policies that, he claimed, weakened academic standards and left students ill-prepared. Citing reforms, he said the government has taken “path-breaking initiatives” aligned with the ideals of B. R. Ambedkar.

Andaman sets Guinness World Record by unfurling largest underwater national flag

Tricolour, measuring approximately 60 by 40 metre, deployed beneath sea in a complex

SRI VIJAYA PURAM: The Andaman and Nicobar administration on Saturday set a new Guinness World Record by unfurling the world's largest underwater national flag at Radhanagar beach, officials said.

The massive Tricolour, measuring approximately 60 by 40 metre, was deployed beneath the sea in a complex, tightly coordinated operation, involving multiple agencies and trained divers at Swaraj Dweep (Havelock Island), they said.

Lieutenant Governor D K Joshi, Chief Secretary Chandra Bhushan Kumar, and Director General of Police H S Dhaliwal, along with senior officials, were present to witness the event.

Personnel from the Andaman and Nicobar Police, Forest Department, Indian Navy, and Indian Coast Guard, as well as scuba divers from various diving centres, collaborated to execute the intricate underwater unfurling.

Three school children – Fateh Jahaan Singh (16),

CLOSER LOOK

- » The tightly coordinated operation involved multiple agencies and trained divers at Swaraj Dweep
- » Lieutenant Governor D K Joshi, Chief Secretary Chandra Bhushan Kumar, and Director General of Police H S Dhaliwal, along with senior officials, were present to witness the event
- » Three school children – Fateh Jahaan Singh (16), Lavanya Eira (15) and Ranvijay Singh (14) – were the youngest participants among over 200 divers
- » Personnel from police, Forest Dept, Navy, and Coast Guard, as well as



Divers set Guinness World Record by unfurling largest national flag underwater at Radhanagar, in Swaraj Dweep, Andaman and Nicobar islands, Saturday

Lavanya Eira (15) and Ranvijay Singh (14) – were the youngest participants among more than 200 divers.

At 10.35 am, Rishi Nath, adjudicator from Guinness World Records, formally confirmed the achievement and presented the certificate to Joshi, the officials said.

Addressing the gather-

ing, Joshi praised the teams involved for their coordination and commitment, calling the feat a significant addition to the islands' record of unique accomplishments.

The achievement highlights the growing stature of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands as a destination for adventure tourism, marine activities, and

globally recognised events, the officials said.

Fateh, a Class-12 student of the Shri Ram School in Gurugram, said: “I don't have words to express how beautiful the marine world is. I am feeling so proud to have become a part of this event.” He is a trained equestrian who has participated in many international events.



गृह मंत्रालय
भारत
सरकार

OUR CENSUS OUR DEVELOPMENT

(First Phase of Census 2027)

Common queries on Self-Enumeration (SE) and their Answers (Part-1)

WHAT IS SELF-ENUMERATION?

Self-Enumeration is an online process in which you fill and submit your household details on the SE portal (se.census.gov.in) yourself, without waiting for an enumerator



- ❖ **Is Self-Enumeration mandatory?**
No, it is an additional facility. If you do not do it, an enumerator will collect data during field visit
- ❖ **Can I do Self-Enumeration in any language?**
This facility is available in Hindi, English and 14 Indian languages
- ❖ **Is internet required for Self-Enumeration?**
Yes, internet is required to access the portal
- ❖ **Is my information safe?**
Yes, all data is secure, encrypted and stored on government servers
- ❖ **What is SE ID and its use?**
After submission of information, you will receive a unique 11 digit SE ID (Also via SMS/email) which must be shown to the enumerator during her/his visit to your house
- ❖ **What if SE ID is forgotten?**
It can be retrieved using the registered mobile number on the portal
- ❖ **Will an enumerator visit after Self-Enumeration?**
Yes, the enumerator will visit your home and confirm your details using the SE ID
- ❖ **Do I need to upload any documents?**
No documents are required to be uploaded
- ❖ **Is help available on the portal?**
Portal has user guide, flowcharts, tutorial videos, FAQs and tooltips



TOLL FREE - 1855

Let us fulfill our responsibility, Let us participate in the Census

CensusIndia2027

CBC 19108/13/0065/2627

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 (2) (ii) Cr. P.C.

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Kewal Krishan Sachdeva R/o H.No. 85, Chanderlok, Pitampura, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 2041/23 U/s 138 NI Act.**, has been registered at **P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Kewal Krishan Sachdeva** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Kewal Krishan Sachdeva** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Kewal Krishan Sachdeva of FIR No. 2041/23 U/s 138 NI Act.**, registered at **P.S. Paschim Vihar West, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **06.06.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Anshul Singhal
DP/5660/OD/2026
(Court Notice)
MM-04 (West), Room No. 268
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-April-07 Dated: 30.04.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N.C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

1	Tender No.: 2026-April-07-01	Approx Cost Rs.: 2710448.35
----------	-------------------------------------	------------------------------------

Description of work: Balance work of Supply & stacking of 60Kg/ 60EI-R260 grade rails AT Welding portions using Compressed Air Petrol preheating system, with prefabricated three piece moulds (Zircon washed) manual pressed using Single shot crucible fitted with Automatic Tapping Thimble (ATT) technology at SSE(P.way)/Agra Depot in Agra division.

2	Tender No.: 2026-April-07-02	Approx Cost Rs.: 7286583.49
----------	-------------------------------------	------------------------------------

Description of work: Construction of female Changing Room along with Rest Room, Female and Male Lockups at RPF post / out post over RPF Agra division..

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15:00 hrs on 22.05.2026 955/26 (ADM)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ **CPRONCR**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-April-07 Dated: 30.04.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), N.C. Rly Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:

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North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ **CPRONCR**

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

D.R.M./C/AGRA/ATVM/Facilitator/2025 Date : 30.04.2026

NOTIFICATION

Calling for application for engagement of facilitators for Automatic Ticket Vending Machines. The Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, Agra Division, Agra- 282001, for and on behalf of the President of India, invites applications from Retired Railway employees, Divyanjan (Only locomotive disability) & General Public, for engagement of facilitators for issue of unserved tickets through Automatic Ticket Vending Machines (ATVMs) installed at stations over Agra Division. The stations and the number of facilitators to be engaged against each are given below.

S. No.	Name of Station	Category of Station	ATVM 70% (Other)	No of Facilitator to be engaged	Duration of Work	ATVM 30% (Divyanjan)	No of Facilitator to be engaged	Duration of Work
1	Agra Cantt	NSG-2	05	00	Contract valid for 31.03.2027	02	06	Contract valid for 06 Months
2	Mathura Jn.	NSG-2	07	08		02	06	
3	Agra Fort	NSG-3	04	06		02	06	
4	Raja Ki Mandi	NSG-4	03	09		01	03	
5	Dholpur Jn.	NSG-4	01	01		01	03	
6	Idgah	NSG-4	01	01	01	03		
7	Kosikalan	NSG-4	01	03	01	03		
8	Bhuteshwar	NSG-5	01	02	01	03		
9	Kherli	NSG-5	01	03	01	03		
Total			24	33		12	36	

The advertisement notice and application form are available in North Central Railway website - <https://ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>

Date of issue of application form at the website	30.04.2026 (Thursday)
Date of availability of application form at website	20.05.2026 (Wednesday)
Last date for submission of completely filled application form	Upto 13:00 Hrs. 21.05.2026 (Thursday)

1. Applications, along with all relevant terms and conditions, can be obtained from the office of the DRM (Commercial), Agra, on any working day (Monday to Friday) between 10:00 AM and 5:00 PM, from the date of notification until 20.05.2026 at 17:00 PM. 2. Application forms can also be downloaded from the North Central Railway website, <https://ncr.indianrailways.gov.in>. The application fee is Rs 1150/- including GST (non-refundable). This amount must be deposited at the Agra Cantt Booking Office, and the original copy of the MR received must be attached to the application form and deposited in the designated box at the Divisional Office. 3. The completed application forms along with all desired documents must be submitted in a sealed cover to the office of the Senior Divisional Commercial Manager, North Central Railway Agra by 13:00 hrs on 21.05.2026. The applications will be opened on 21.05.2026 at 15:30 in front of the assembled people. If the said date is declared a holiday for any reason, the applications will be opened on the next working day at the same place and time. 4. Applications received late/incomplete/wrongly filled/desired document not attached will not consider and will summarily rejected. 5. Railway administration reserves the right to postpone/modify or to cancel any one or all the application without assigning any reason. Asst. Commercial Manager 973/26 (ADM) N.C.R. Agra

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ **CPRONCR**

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Name: **Karan Preet Singh, S/o.: Nanak Singh, R/o.: H. No. B-25, Asha Park, Gali No. 3, Hari Nagar, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.361/2021 U/S 356/379/411 IPC** registered at **P.S Tilak Nagar, West District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Karan Preet Singh** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Karan Preet Singh** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Karan Preet Singh**, accused of **FIR No.361/2021 U/S 356/379/411 IPC** registered at **P.S Tilak Nagar, West District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **24.06.2026**.

By Order, **Sh. Vikas Madaan,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (West),
Court No. 289, Second Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5753/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-006-2026-27 Date: 29.04.2026

E- TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

Tender No.006/ **Name of work:** (A) S&T works in c/w Provision of yard remodeling work in PRYJ end & HWH end at Chunar. Jn. and (B) Provision of 02 rake handling capacity at a time in Chunar goods shed.

Approx. Cost of work(₹) : ₹ 97613507.74	Earnest Money(₹) : ₹ 1952300/-
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Cost of Tender Form : 0.00	Completion Period: 18 Months
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Date of Opening of tender: 28.05.2026

2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in. **3. Earnest Money to be deposited :** The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **4.Time & place of opening tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **5. Validity of offer :** 60 days from the date of opening. **6. Right of Railway to deal with tender :** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 959/26(DG)

North central railways @ **CPRONCR** @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

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By Order, **Sh. Vikas Madaan,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-07 (West),
Court No. 289, Second Floor,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5753/WD/2026
(Court Matter)

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-006-2026-27 Date: 29.04.2026

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Cost of Tender Form : 0.00	Completion Period: 18 Months
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North central railways @ **CPRONCR** @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender No. PRYJ-Sig-006-2026-27 Date: 29.04.2026

E- TENDER NOTICE

Senior Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer / Coordination / North Central Railway/ Prayagraj, for and on behalf of the President of India, invite **E-TENDER** on prescribed form for the following works up to 12.00 hrs. on the opening date of E-tender mentioned therein. **The details of the Tender are as under:-**

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Cost of Tender Form : 0.00	Completion Period: 18 Months
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Date of Opening of tender: 28.05.2026

2. Availability of tender form: Tender forms are available on www.ireps.gov.in. **3. Earnest Money to be deposited :** The prescribed amount of Bid Security as mentioned above must be deposited along with the tender form Online through Internet Banking or Online Payment gateway only. The tenderer(s) should note that, in any case, the Bid Security in any other form than specified in GCC shall be acceptable. If the Bid Security deposited by the bidder is in shape of Bank Guarantee, it should be supported by proper stamp duty, rate prescribed as per section 13 & 24 of the UP Stamp Act, 2008 and amended from time to time at the time of submission of Bank Guarantee. Tenders without Bid Security shall be summarily rejected. **4.Time & place of opening tender:** Tender will be opened through E-tender at office of Divisional Railway Manager, Prayagraj at or after 12.30 hours. In case tender opening date happens to be holiday, Tenders will be opened on the next working day. **5. Validity of offer :** 60 days from the date of opening. **6. Right of Railway to deal with tender :** Railway administration reserves the rights to postpone/modify or to cancel the tender without assigning any reasons. 959/26(DG)

North central railways @ **CPRONCR** @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tender Notice No.: JHS-N-W-36-26 Date : 29.04.2026

E-Tender Notice

Sr. Divisional Signal & Telecommunication Engineer/Jhansi, DRM's office, Jhansi, for and on behalf of President of India invite open Tender through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following works.

E-Tender No.: JHS-N-W-36-26, **Description of work:** Provision of S&T work in connection with elimination of sharp curve in RRU yard G.C. line behind PI292A.

Approx. Cost : ₹ 1,07,84,761.11/-	Earnest Money : ₹ 2,15,700/-
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Cost of Tender Form : Nil	Opening of Tender : 25.05.2026 Time 15:00
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Completion period from issue of letter of acceptance : 12 Months

(1) Tender on line can be submitted up to 15.00 hrs on 25.05.2026. (2) For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in (NORTH CENTRAL RLY/JHANSI DIVISION-S AND T) 953/26 (MG)

North central railways @ **CPRONCR** @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

(E-TENDERING TENDER NOTICE)

Chief Project Manager, Gati Shakti, N.C. Railway, Jhansi for and behalf of President of India invites sealed "Open Tender" through on Line (E-Tendering) for the following work.

E-Tender No.	Approx Cost (Rs)	Earnest Money (Rs)
JHS-ENGG-GSU-2026-03	95462149.25	1909300.00

Description of work: Khajuraho-setting-up an Electric Locomotive Trip Shed at Khajuraho.

Date of closing Tender: 28.05.2026

Date of completion/period from issue acceptance letter : 12 month

• Tender online can be submitted up to 10:30 hrs on 28.05.2026. • For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website www.ireps.gov.in. 957/26 (ADM)

North central railways @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in @ **CPRONCR**

ZONAL HEADQUARTERS CICE CRIME BRANCH JAMMU

LOOK OUT NOTICE

The public in general is hereby informed through medium of this "LOOK OUT NOTICE" that the present whereabouts of the person whose photograph is pasted above are required for the purpose of investigation in case Case FIR No. 02/2025 U/S U/S 318(4)/61(2)/BNS r/w 66-D/IT Act 2000 registered at Police Station, Crime Branch, Jammu presently lying under investigation with P/S CICE Jammu and his alleged name and particulars are as under:-

I) Name : Sunil Kumar
II) Parentage : Rajpal
III) Address : 102 ward 4 Shergarh
Tapu 56 Karnal,
Haryana, Pin Code- 132023

IV) Date of Birth: 08/03/1975
V) Sex : Male.

Anybody having any information about the whereabouts of above mentioned person may please contact the office of Sr. Superintendent of Police CICE, Crime Branch Jammu personally or may share the information on Email ID psdice.jmu@jkpolice.gov.in or Mobile No. 7006771753 of Investigating Officer.-
Sd/-
Sr. Superintendent of Police
CICE, Crime Branch, Jammu

DIP No:DIP/J-1452/26

UJVN LIMITED

(An Uttarakhand Govt. Enterprise)

H.O. "UJJAWAL" MAHARANI BAGH, GMS ROAD, DEHRADUN - 248006. CN No. U40101UR2002025866
Tele.: 0135-2763508, 2763808, Fax: 0135-2763507, website: www.ujvn.com

Tender No.370 Date : 02.05.2026

e-Tender Notice

Office of the Executive Engineer (Monitoring) "Ujjwal", GMS Road, Dehradun, invites sealed tenders from interested parties. Brief summary of tender is given below :

Tender No. 01/EE(M)/2026-27
Name of work: **Carrying out Benchmarking Study of all operational Power Stations of UJVN Limited**

Estimated cost : ₹ 38,00,000/-Only (Exclusive of Tax)

Date of availability of bid document on website:04-05-2026 at 17:00Hrs
Last date for submission of bids on website:25-05-2026 up to 16:00 Hrs
For fuller & further details, kindly visit e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in> Executive Engineer (Monitoring), Ujjwal Maharani Bagh, GMS Road, Dehradun

"Avoid wasteful use of Electricity"

NORTH CENTRAL RAILWAY

E-Tendering Notice No.: 2026-April-05 Dated: 29.04.2026

E-TENDERING NOTICE

Divisional Railway Manager (Engineering), North Central Railway Agra for and on behalf of the President of India invites "Open Tender" through on Line only (E-Tendering) for the following works. The details of the tender are as under:-

S.No.: 1	Tender No.: 2026-April-05-01	Approx. Cost (Rs.): ₹ 7084665.25
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Description of work: Repair and maintenance associated works/activities for service building and staff quarters in jurisdiction of ADEN/DHO for one year.

S.No.: 2	Tender No.: 2026-April-05-02	Approx. Cost (Rs.): ₹ 9600184.26
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Description of work: Construction of 20 Bed (Male & Female) RPF Barrack at Achhnera Railway Station for the use of RPF staff.

S.No.: 3	Tender No.: 2026-April-05-03	Approx. Cost (Rs.): ₹ 6263259.82
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Description of work: Supply and stacking of 60 Kg/60 EI R260 grade rails AT welding portions under jurisdiction of Sr. DEN-II/Agra.

For full details and submission of bid please see the Indian Railways website "www.ireps.gov.in". Tenders can only be submitted through web portal "www.ireps.gov.in" up to 15.00 hrs on 18.05.2026. 960/26 (A)

North central railways @ **CPRONCR** @ www.ncr.indianrailways.gov.in

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Name: **Vikram @ Kartik, S/o.: Soni, R/o.: Jhuggi No. 86, Lawrence Road Industrial Area, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.3957/2019 U/S 411 IPC** registered at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Central District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vikram @ Kartik** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Vikram @ Kartik** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vikram @ Kartik**, accused of **FIR No.3957/2019 U/S 411 IPC** registered at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Central District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**.

By Order, **Dr. Raj Kumar Singh**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (Central),
Central District, Room No. 241,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5769/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PHYSICAL POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

The Authorised ICICI Bank Officer under the Securitisation, Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13(12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002, issued Demand Notices to the borrower(s) mentioned below, to repay the amount mentioned in the Notice within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said Notice. Having failed to repay the amount, the Notice is issued to the borrower and the public in general that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described below, by exercising powers conferred on him/her under Section 13(4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of the said rules on the below-mentioned dates. The borrower in particular and the public in general are hereby cautioned not to deal with the property. Any dealings with the property will be subject to charges of ICICI Bank Limited.

Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Physical Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Himanshu Gupta/ Asha Gupta/ TBFDB00006485827	Flat No C-1402 14th Floor, Ahinsha Naturez Park Situated At Gh-06, Revenue Estate of Village Sarai Khwaja, Sector 41, Faridabad Haryana- 121001/ 29 Apr, 2026	December 12, 2024 Rs. 78,34,986.96/-	Delhi & NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: May 03, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused person Name: **Vikram @ Kartik, S/o.: Soni, R/o.: Jhuggi No. 86, Lawrence Road Industrial Area, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No.3957/2019 U/S 411 IPC** registered at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Central District, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Vikram @ Kartik** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that accused **Vikram @ Kartik** is absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Vikram @ Kartik**, accused of **FIR No.3957/2019 U/S 411 IPC** registered at **P.S. Nabi Karim, Central District, Delhi** is required to appear before the court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026**.

By Order, **Dr. Raj Kumar Singh**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (Central),
Central District, Room No. 241,
Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5769/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PHYSICAL POSSESSION NOTICE

ICICI Bank Branch Office: ICICI Bank Limited Plot No-23, Shal Tower, 3rd Floor, New Rohtak Road, Karol Bagh, New Delhi- 110005

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Sr. No.	Name of the Borrower(s)/ Loan Account Number	Description of Property/ Date of Physical Possession	Date of Demand Notice/ Amount in Demand Notice (Rs)	Name of Branch
1.	Himanshu Gupta/ Asha Gupta/ TBFDB00006485827	Flat No C-1402 14th Floor, Ahinsha Naturez Park Situated At Gh-06, Revenue Estate of Village Sarai Khwaja, Sector 41, Faridabad Haryana- 121001/ 29 Apr, 2026	December 12, 2024 Rs. 78,34,986.96/-	Delhi & NCR

The above-mentioned borrower(s)/guarantor(s) is/are hereby issued a 30 day Notice to repay the amount, else the mortgaged properties will be sold after 30 days from the date of publishing this Notice, as per the provisions under Rules 8 and 9 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules 2002.

Date: May 03, 2026
Place: Delhi & Ncr

Sincerely Authorised Officer,
For ICICI Bank Ltd.

KREMLIN CLAIMS FRONT-LINE PROGRESS

Ukraine: Russian drone strike on Kherson minibus kills two

KYIV: Two people were killed after a Russian drone attacked a minibus in the southern Ukrainian city of Kherson, local officials said Saturday, in the latest barrage of civilian areas, a hallmark of Moscow's full-scale invasion of its neighbour.

Seven people were also wounded in the attack, regional head Oleksandr Prokudin said. Hours later Russia attacked another minibus in Kherson, wounding the driver, he said.

On Ukraine's Black Sea coast, a Russian strike damaged port infrastructure in the city of Odesa. No casualties were reported. Ukrainian civilians have endured relentless air assaults since Russia launched a full-scale invasion of its neighbour more than four years ago.

US-brokered talks between Moscow and Kyiv over the past year have brought no respite, with Russia rejecting Ukraine's



Firefighters put out a fire a building following a Russian drone attack in Odesa region, Ukraine, Saturday

offer of a ceasefire, and in recent weeks the Iran war has diverted international attention from Ukraine's plight.

Meanwhile, on the roughly 1,250-km (750-mile) front line, Russia claimed Saturday it had taken control of the village of Myropillia in Ukraine's north-eastern Sumy region. It was not possible to independently ver-

ify the battlefield claims.

In Russia, local officials in the Krasnodar region said that a fire that broke out Friday following a Ukrainian strike on an oil terminal in the Black Sea city of Tuapse was put out on Saturday.

Ukrainian drones have hit the oil refinery and export terminal in Tuapse on four occa-

HIGHLIGHTS

- » On Ukraine's Black Sea coast, a Russian strike damaged port infrastructure in the city of Odesa
- » US-brokered talks between Moscow and Kyiv over the past year have brought no respite, with Russia rejecting Ukraine's offer of a ceasefire, reports said

sions in just over two weeks, sparking fires that prompted local evacuations and sent up massive plumes of smoke.

Ukraine has escalated its long-distance strikes against Russian oil facilities in an effort to slash Moscow's oil exports, a key source of funding for its grinding invasion of Ukraine. AGENCIES

US to pull 5,000 troops from Germany in coming months

WASHINGTON: The United States will withdraw about 5,000 troops from Germany in the next six to 12 months, the Pentagon said Friday, fulfilling President Donald Trump's threat as he clashes with the German leader over the US war with Iran.

Trump had threatened to withdraw some troops from the NATO ally earlier this week after Chancellor Friedrich Merz said the US was being "humiliated" by the Iranian leadership and criticised Washington's lack of strategy in the war.

Pentagon spokesman Sean Parnell said in a statement that the "decision follows a thorough review of the Department's force posture in Europe and is in recognition of theatre requirements and conditions on the ground."

Germany hosts several US military facilities, including the headquarters of its European and Africa commands, Ramstein Air Base and a medical centre in Landstuhl, where casualties from the wars in Afghanistan and Iraq were treated. US nuclear missiles are also stationed in the country.

Fresh faces, big dreams

India select Yastika, uncapped Nandini for women's T20 WC

MUMBAI: India on Saturday drafted in Bharti Fulmali, wicketkeeper-batter Yastika Bhatia and uncapped Nandini Sharma in the 15-player squad for the upcoming three-match T20I tour of England followed by the Women's T20 World Cup, starting on June 12.

While specialist batters Pratika Rawal and Harleen Deol were excluded, all-rounder Amanjot Kaur and seamer Kashvee Gautam missed out on selection owing to injuries.

Harmanpreet Kaur will lead the Indian side with Smriti Mandhana being her deputy.

Pratika, however, has been named in the squad for the one-off Test against England to be played at the Lord's between July 10-13 whereas Harleen will lead the India A side in the white ball tour to England.

The selectors preferred Yastika's experience and skills behind the wickets over Pratika.

"There was a discussion on it," chairperson of selectors Amita Sharma told reporters here at the BCCI headquarters during the post-selection press conference.

"Since Yastika is more experienced and also gives an option of being a top-order batter along with being a wicket-keeper, so we went in that direction," Amit added.

Medium pacer Nandini was handed her maiden India call-up after doing well in WPL, where she played 10 matches for Delhi Capitals, taking 17 wickets. She was also part of the India squad that played in the Women's Asia Cup Rising Stars tournament in Bangkok in February this year.

The fast bowling line-up also does not feature Pooja Vastrakar, as Renuka Singh Thakur will continue to lead



Harmanpreet Kaur-led India will open their campaign in the T20 World Cup against Pakistan

BCCI

direction," Amit added.

Medium pacer Nandini was handed her maiden India call-up after doing well in WPL, where she played 10 matches for Delhi Capitals, taking 17 wickets. She was also part of the India squad that played in the Women's Asia Cup Rising Stars tournament in Bangkok in February this year.

The fast bowling line-up also does not feature Pooja Vastrakar, as Renuka Singh Thakur will continue to lead

Squad

Harmanpreet Kaur (c), Smriti Mandhana (vc), Shafali Verma, Jemimah Rodrigues, Bharti Fulmali, Deepti Sharma, Richa Ghosh (wk), Sree Charani, Yastika Bhatia (2nd wk), Nandini Sharma, Arundhati Reddy, Renuka Thakur, Kranti Gaud, Shreyanka Patil, Radha Yadav

hati Reddy and Kranti Goud behind her.

Harmanpreet said Amanjot has been sidelined for the next "4-5 months".

"Amanjot is one of our key players but unfortunately she is not available, she is away from cricket for (the next) 4-5 months now," she said.

"It was very difficult to find someone in her place but we will try someone like Bharti, whatever opportunities she has got, she has tried to prove herself," Harmanpreet said.

DC's Ashutosh enjoys finishing off matches

JAIPUR: Delhi Capitals battling all-rounder Ashutosh Sharma said he relishes his role as a finisher after his side snapped a three-match losing streak with a seven-wicket win over Rajasthan Royals in an IPL match here.

Ashutosh struck an unbeaten 25 off 15 balls, hitting four boundaries, as Delhi successfully chased down a daunting 226-run target with five balls to spare on Friday.

"I enjoy being a finisher for my team. The team has trusted me to bat in these situations and I enjoy playing in these moments. I always feel that as long as I am at the crease, I can win the game for my team," Ashutosh said at the post-match press conference.

Chasing a stiff total, Delhi were laid a solid foundation by KL Rahul and Pathum Nissanka, who stitched together a

The team has trusted me to bat in these situations and I enjoy playing in these moments

Ashutosh Sharma

110-run opening partnership.

"In T20 cricket nowadays, a lot depends on the opening partnership and the powerplay. Our openers played really well and because of that we were in the game throughout and could take it till the end," he said.

Meanwhile, Rajasthan Royals batting coach Vikram Rathour admitted that poor execution with the ball cost his side the match.

OUTCLASS MI TO BOOST PLAYOFF CHANCES

MI misery continues as CSK roll them over

CHENNAI: Chennai Super Kings produced a thoroughly professional display to outclass Mumbai Indians by eight wickets in a critical Indian Premier League match and significantly boost their playoff prospects here on Saturday.

Afghanistan left-arm spinner Noor Ahmad led a disciplined bowling effort to help CSK restrict a lacklustre Mumbai Indians to 159 for seven.

Noor returned excellent figures of 2/26 in four overs while Anshul Kamboj grabbed 3/32, even as Naman Dhir top-scored for MI with 57 off 37 balls in an insipid display by the visitors after winning the toss. Captain Hardik Pandya consumed 23 balls for his 18, reflecting MI's struggles.

Pandya's counterpart Ruturaj Gaikwad then led by example with an unbeaten 48-ball 67 and he was well sup-



CSK's captain Ruturaj Gaikwad led from the front

PTI

ported by Kartik Sharma (54 not out off 40 balls) and Urvil Patel (24 off 12 balls).

In the chase, CSK's man in form Sanju Samson was quick off the blocks with a couple of boundaries but Jasprit Bumrah cut short his stay with a beautiful outswinger that took the outside edge and Ryan Rick-

with Urvil Patel hitting him for two sixes and a four before Ruturaj got a maximum against AM Ghazanfar.

Ghazanfar, though, dismissed Patel as the batter played the ball on to his stumps. Gaikwad and Sharma then took CSK home.

Earlier, Mukesh Choudhary started the proceedings for CSK on an excellent note, conceding just one run in the opening over and then IPL debutant Ramakrishna made immediate impact with a stunning catch to send back Will Jacks in the second over bowled by Anshul Kamboz.

Off a length ball outside off, Jacks stepped out and tried to hoick but failed to connect as Ramakrishna ran in from deep backward point and dived to complete the catch, leaving the crowd at MA Chidambaram Stadium delighted.

Sinner on overdrive

Adrenaline rush fuels Sinner's Madrid charge



Jannik Sinner beat Arthur Fils 6-2 6-4

AP

MADRID: Jannik Sinner said the surge of adrenaline that comes with high-stakes matches has helped him push through mounting fatigue after reaching his maiden final at the Madrid Open.

The 24-year-old has been on a relentless run over the past six weeks, consistently going deep into tournaments as the ATP Tour transitioned from hard courts to the clay season. During this stretch, Sinner captured titles at the Indian Wells, Miami Open and Monte Carlo Masters, underlining his dominance across surfaces.

"I've played a lot in the last one and a half months, going very deep in tournaments," Sinner told reporters after defeating Arthur Fils 6-2, 6-4 in the Madrid semi-finals on Friday.

"It's a good sign, of course, and at the same time you tend to get a little bit more tired."

Despite the physical toll, Sinner explained that the intensity of big matches provides an extra lift. "I think and I believe, when I play big matches—semi-finals, quarter-finals, finals—there's also a little bit of adrenaline that pushes me," he said.

4

Sinner is the fourth and youngest man to reach the final at all nine Masters 1000s

The Italian will now face Alexander Zverev in Sunday's final. A victory would secure Sinner's fifth consecutive Masters 1000 title, a remarkable streak dating back to Paris last year, and further cement his status as the form player on tour.

However, Sinner remains focused on the immediate challenge in Madrid before turning his attention to the Italian Open in Rome. "I'm of course very happy to play my first final here. It means a lot to me," he said. "Whatever happens on Sunday, it has been a great tournament." "In between here and Rome I'll try to recover as much as possible."

Kostyuk wins title

MADRID: Marta Kostyuk overpowered Mirra Andreeva 6-3 7-5 in a commanding one hour and 20 minutes to win the Madrid Open title on Saturday, sealing only the third singles crown of her career.

The Ukrainian, whose only previous triumphs came in Austin in 2023 and Rouen last month, arrived in the Spanish capital on a mission and left with silverware after a display brimming with intent and nerve. "It feels unbelievable," Kostyuk said.

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Jogender Singh Civil Judge (Senior Division), Bhiwani

Jitender Singh Vs GENERAL PUBLIC

CNR No. HRBH02-000366-2026 CIS No. GW/02/2026 Next Date 16-05-2026

PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: General Public

India

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **16-05-2026 at 10:00 am.**

For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice & district = Bhiwani

Sd/- Sh. Jogender Singh Civil Judge (Senior Division) Bhiwani Dated 01.05-2026

COURT NOTICE (U/o 5 Rule 20 CPC) IN THE COURT OF Sh. Sohan Lal Malik Rent Controller, Bhiwani

Beena Devi @Veena Vs Sumitra

CNR No. HRBH02-000266-2019 Next Date 13-05-2026

Suit for Partition PUBLICATION ISSUED TO: 4 SUSHMA D/O MURARI LAL 52. KEDARNATH S/O MURARI S/O MADAN 56. ANIL S/O MURARILAL 57. GAURAV S/O ANIL S/O MURARI LAL 58. HOSHIYAR S/O RAMKALA S/O GIRDALA 63. MAHENDER S/O NANAK S/O ANGNAMAL ALL R/O CHOKHANI ESTATE, MEHAM ROAD BHIWANI, BHIWANI

In above titled case, the defendant (s)/ respondent(s) could not be served. It is ordered that defendant(s)/ respondent(s) should appear in person or through counsel on **13-05-2026 at 10:00 am.**

For details login to https://highcourtchd.gov.in/?mod=district_notice & district = Bhiwani

Sd/- Sh. Sohan Lal Malik Rent Controller Bhiwani Dated 01.05-2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita-2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Wasim S/o MD. Nazar R/o H.No. E-49, Gali No.4, Dayalpur, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 28177/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC at PS: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Wasim** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Wasim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Wasim of FIR No. 28177/2021 U/s 379/411 IPC of PS: Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.06.2026.**

By order
Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03
Room No.19, First Floor, Shahdara District Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/5383/NE/2026

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER-J/JI DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 2)
1st Floor, SCO 33-34-35, Sector 17-A, Chandigarh (Additional Space allotted on 3rd & 4th Floor also)

DEMAND NOTICE

NOTICE UNDER SECTIONS 25 TO 28 OF THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS & BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993 AND RULE 2 OF SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961

BANK OF MAHARASHTRA 09.02.2026

versus

SH. AMRIT MISHRA AND OTHERS

To
(CD 1) Sh. Amrit Mishra and Others
S/o Sh. Satish Sharma, R/o House No. B-304, Saheta Apartments, Sector 4, Dwarka, New Delhi.
(CD 2) Smt. Sneha Dutta W/o Sh. Satish Mishra, R/o House No. B-304, Saheta Apartments, Sector 4, Dwarka, New Delhi.
(CD 3) M/s VXL Realtor Private Limited, through its Director - Sh. Prabjit Singh, having its Registered Office at 5th Floor, Ajit Singh House, 12 DDA Community Centre, Yusuf Sarai, New Delhi - 110049.
(CD 4) Sh. Prabjit Singh, Director M/s VXL Realtor Private Limited, having its Registered Office at 5th Floor, Ajit Singh House, 12 DDA, Community Centre, Yusuf Sarai, New Delhi - 110049.

This is to notify that as per the Recovery Certificate issued in pursuance of orders passed by the Presiding Officer, DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 2) in OA/1735/2017 an amount of Rs. 43,08,499/- (Rupees Forty Three Lakhs Eight Thousand Four Hundred Ninety Nine only) along with pendentlite and future interest @7% Simple Interest Yearly w.e.f. 22.03.2016 till realization and costs of Rs. 46,000/- (Rupees Forty Six Thousand only) has become due against you (Jointly and Severally / Fully / Limited).

2. You are hereby directed to pay the above sum within 15 days of the receipts of the notice, failing which the recovery shall be made in accordance with the Recovery of Debts Due to Banks and Financial Institutions Act, 1993 and Rules there under.

3. You are hereby ordered to declare on an affidavit the particulars of your assets on or before the next date of hearing.

4. You are hereby ordered to appear before the undersigned on **08.05.2026 at 10:30 a.m.** for further proceedings.

5. In addition to the sum aforesaid, you will also be liable to pay:-
(a) Such interests as is payable for the period commencing immediately after this notice of the certificate / execution proceedings.
(b) All costs, charges and expenses incurred in respect of the service of this notice and warrants and other processes and all other proceedings taken for recovering the amount due.

Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: **09.02.2026.**

RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 2)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82(2) (ii) Cr. P.C./84 Bhartiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita

Whereas a complaint has been made before me that accused person Namley **Vijay Verma S/o Lt. Sh. Heera Nand R/o WZ-105, East Uttam Nagar, Delhi**, have committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence under **FIR No. 291/2022 U/s 36/65 C.R Act & 103/104 TM Act.**, has been registered at **P.S. Wazirabad, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said, **Vijay Verma** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said, **Vijay Verma** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused, **Vijay Verma** of under **FIR No. 291/2022 U/s 36/65 C.R Act & 103/104 TM Act.**, has been, registered at **PS. Wazirabad, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **04.06.2026.**

By Order
Harshita Mishra
Ld. CJM (Central), Room No. 38
Ground Floor, Tis Hazari Courts, Delhi

DP/5772/N/2026
(Court Notice)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr. P.C & 84 BNSS

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused Person(s) **Ismail Qureshi @ Jonny S/o MD. Aqram, R/o: H.No. 177 Gali Mata Wali Chhata Lal Miyan Daryaganj Chandni Mahal, Delhi**, has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **CC No. 36147/2022, U/s: 406 IPC, PS: Daryaganj, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Ismail Qureshi @ Jonny** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Ismail Qureshi @ Jonny** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person (s) **Ismail Qureshi @ Jonny of CC No. 36147/2022, U/s: 406 IPC , PS: Daryaganj, Delh** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026.**

By Order
Dr. Raj Kumar Singh
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (Central)
NI ACT-05 Room No. 241
Tis Hazari Court, Delhi

DP/5606/CD/2026
(Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC / 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS))

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Arti W/o Sitaram, R/o H.No. Jhuggi No. F-1263, F-Block, Shahabad Dairy, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 1004/2019, U/s 379/411 IPC Act. at P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrants of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Arti** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Arti** have absconded (or is concealing herself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Arti, FIR No. 1004/2019, U/s 379/411 IPC Act. of P.S. Shahbad Dairy, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **08.06.2026.**

By order
Ms. Bharti Beniwal
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (North)
Court Room No. 114, 1st Floor, Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/5601/ON/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF A PERSON ACCUSED

(See Section 82 Cr. PC)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person namely **Mahesh Kumar, Proprietor of M/s Core Construction O/o: B-26, 1st Floor, Shivalki Malviya Nagar, New Delhi**, Also at : **H.No.: 370-A, Top Floor, Santnagar East of Kailash, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **CC No. 2769/2021 U/s 138 NI Act at P.S. Kirti Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrants of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mahesh Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mahesh Kumar** have absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Mahesh Kumar of CC No. 2769/2021 U/s 138 NI Act of P.S. Kirti Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **05.06.2026.**

By order
Gurave Singal
Judicial Magistrate, First Class-06 (West), Room No. 355, Tis Hazari Court, New Delhi

DP/5793/WD/2026

OFFICE OF THE RECOVERY OFFICER-J/JI DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 3)
Ground Floor, SCO 33-34-35, Sector 17-A, Chandigarh - 160017

NOTICE FOR SETTLING A SALE PROCLAMATION UNDER RULE 53 OF THE SECOND SCHEDULE TO THE INCOME TAX ACT, 1961 READ WITH THE RECOVERY OF DEBTS & BANKRUPTCY ACT, 1993.

Exh. No. 1479
30-04-2026

RC/138/2026

BANK OF BARODA
Versus

M/s NEELAM DYEING AND PRINTING HOUSE PVT. LTD. AND OTHERS

To
(CD 1) M/s Neelam Dyeing and Printing House Pvt. Ltd., a Private Limited Company, through Principal Officer / Director/s Registered Office: 106/781, DG Road, Dev Nagar, Karol Bagh, New Delhi - 110005.
Also at:- Factory Address:- B-30/5349/D-327, Phase-VIII, Focal Point, Ludhiana, Punjab-141010.
(CD 2) Sh. Sandeep Singh S/o Sh. Krishan Pal Singh
1st Address:- House No. B-19/1-A, Ward No. 54, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
2nd Address:- House No. A-1, A-2, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
3rd Address:- B-30/5349/D-327, Phase-VIII, Focal Point, Ludhiana - 141010.
(CD 3) Smt. Neha Singh W/o Sh. Sandeep Singh
1st Address:- House No. B-19/1-A, Ward No. 54, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
2nd Address:- House No. A-1, A-2, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
3rd Address:- B-30/5349/D-327, Phase-VIII, Focal Point, Ludhiana - 141010.
(CD 4) M/s Neelam Dyeing and Printing House, a Proprietorship firm through its Proprietor Sh. Gaurav Arora.
1st Address:- House No. 169/E, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
2nd Address:- House No. 169/E, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
3rd Address:- Gali No. 1, Kirpal Nagar, Near Tajpur Chowk, Ludhiana - 141007.
4th Address:- House No. 169/E, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.
(CD 5) Sh. Gaura Arora S/o Sh. Nalin Arora
1st Address:- Gali No. 1, Kirpal Nagar, Near Tajpur Chowk, Ludhiana - 141007.
2nd Address:- House No. 169/E, Kitchlu Nagar, Ludhiana - 141001.

Whereas you the was ordered by the Presiding Officer of DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 3) who had issued the Recovery Certificate dated 21.01.2026 in OA/2017/2021 to pay to the Applicant Bank(s) / Financial Institution(s) Name of applicant, the sum of Rs. 10,14,92,903.73 (Rupees Ten Crores Fourteen Lakhs Ninety Two Thousands Nine Hundred Threes and Paise Seventy Three only) along with future interest @8.00% w.e.f. 02.11.2021 till realization and costs of Rs. 1,50,000/- (Rupees One Lakh Fifty Thousands only) and whereas the said has not been paid, the undersigned has ordered the sale of undermentioned immovable / immovable property.

2. You are hereby informed that the **25.05.2026 at 10:30 A.M.** has been fixed for drawing up the proclamation of sale and settling the terms thereof. You are requested to bring to the notice of the undersigned any encumbrances, charges, claims or liabilities attached to the said properties or any portion thereof.

Specification of Property

The property is a Leased Industrial Property bearing Plot No. D-327, Phase-VIII, Focal Point Ludhiana - 141010, Having Land Area 2566.66 Sq. Yds. as per Deed, GF+1 Storeis (Heigh - 10' Each Floor), owned by M/s Neelam Dyeing & Printing House (Prop. Mr. Gaurav Arora S/o Mr. N.K. Arora).

Given under my hand and the seal of the Tribunal, on this date: **30.04.2026.**

RECOVERY OFFICER
DEBTS RECOVERY TRIBUNAL CHANDIGARH (DRT 3)



Fractured Frontier

AS NAGA-KUKI TENSIONS ENTER MANIPUR’S ETHNIC CRISIS, OLD LAND CLAIMS, BORDER ANXIETIES AND INSURGENT HISTORIES DEEPEN AN ALREADY WOUNDED STATE

AUTHOR



DIPANKAR DEY

On May 3, 2023, exactly three years before, a bloody ethnic violence between the Meitei and Kuki began in Manipur, after a ‘tribal solidarity march’ opposed the Meitei community’s demand for Scheduled Tribe status. The ethnic crisis, which has already paralysed the state where more than 250 people have died and over 60,000 remain displaced, got further worsened and complicated after the involvement of the Naga community in the on-going Meitei – Kuki conflict. Clashes erupted between the Naga and Kuki communities when local police attempted to clear a roadblock during a protest shutdown called by the United Naga Council along the border areas of Senapati and adjoining Kangpokpi districts. The roadblock had been set up by Naga volunteers to enforce a three-day shutdown in protest against the April 18 killing of two persons by alleged Kuki militants in Ukhrul district. The hostilities between the Nagas and the Kukis have opened another fault line in the three-year-old Manipur conflict. Until recently, the Nagas had remained neutral while the Meiteis and Kuki-Zos fought each other.

Repeated Naga-Kuki conflicts

The hill areas of Manipur are home to 41.20 per cent of the tribal population. The Kuki-Zo group (16 per cent) occupies the foothills in the districts of Kangpokpi, Churachandpur (Lamka), and Tengnoupal. The Naga tribes (20 per cent) live in the higher, rugged ranges in the districts of Tamenglong, Senapati, and Ukhrul. The Meiteis are the dominant group living in Manipur, though there is a sizeable number of Meiteis in Myanmar. As per the last census conducted in 2011, the Meiteis constitute 43 per cent of the valley population. They live alongside the indigenous Pangan (Muslims), Naga, Nepali, and migrants from other parts of India. It may be recalled that, on September 13, 1993, Naga militants allegedly belonging to the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (Isak-Muivah) - NSCN (IM) massacred around 115 Kuki civilians in the hills of Manipur. The Kukis refer to the killings as the Joupri massacre, after the village that saw the highest number of casualties. The hostility between the Nagas and the Kukis dates back to colonial times. The 1990s conflict was primarily over land: large swathes of what the Kukis claim to be their “homeland” in the Manipur hills, overlapped with Greater Nagaland, or Nagalim, envisioned by the NSCN (IM) as a sovereign Naga homeland. The proposed map of Nagalim consists of Nagaland and “all contiguous Naga-inhabited areas” of Assam, Manipur, Arunachal Pradesh, and, across the international border, Myanmar. On February 17, 2026, NSCN-IM alleged that the ongoing clash between the Meiteis and the Kukis in Manipur, the burning and destruction of Naga houses in Ukhrul district, and unprovoked attacks on Nagas in Nagaland were a pure and simple pretext to legitimise the creation of a territorial entity — Kuki State/ Kuki homeland. The NSCN-IM also claimed that Indian-backed Kuki militants were being weaponised in a proxy war to fragment “Nagalim”.The Naga outfit described Kukis as pawns in a broader strategy to divide Naga



territory. It further alleged that Kuki cadres are being exported to Myanmar as fighters for the People’s Defence Force (PDF).

Flawed India-Myanmar border

Several Ethnic Armed Organisations (EAOs) are active along the India-Myanmar border. The principal ethnic groups inhabiting this region include the Naga, Kuki, Chin, Mizo, and Meitei communities, distributed across India’s north-eastern states—particularly Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, and parts of Arunachal Pradesh—and Myanmar’s Sagaing Region, Chin State, and northern Kachin areas. The key EAOs fighting the military junta include the Arakan Army (AA), Chin National Front (CNF), Kachin Independence Army (KIA), and the All Burma Students’ Democratic Front (ABSDF), Zomi Revolutionary Army (ZRA). These groups maintain a close relationship with various insurgent groups of the northeastern states. The military coup in Myanmar in February 2021 met with widespread resistance against the Regime from various ethnic groups living in the border states of Myanmar. The civil disobedience movement against military rule subsequently evolved into armed resistance by the People’s Defence Forces (PDFs). The synchronised attacks by the PDFs and the Ethnic Armed Organisations (EAOs) pushed the Myanmar military (Tatmadaw) to cede control over large parts of the country. Scholarly studies reveal that in the pre-colonial era, the frontier zones between present-day Northeast India and Myanmar constituted an integrated socio-cultural and economic space. Indigenous communities such as the Naga, Kuki, Chin, Mizo, and Meitei inhabited contiguous territories governed by customary laws, clan-based institutions, and decentralised political systems. Territorial boundaries were fluid, facilitating mobility for trade, intermarriage, ritual exchange, and social interaction. Traditional trade networks connecting the Brahmaputra and Chindwin river basins enabled economic

interdependence and cultural assimilation, reinforcing shared ethnic identities that transcended territorial divisions.

The advent of British colonial rule in the nineteenth century fundamentally altered this spatial order. Colonial boundary demarcation, particularly following the Anglo-Burmese treaties, imposed rigid administrative borders across ethnically homogeneous landscapes. This artificial partition fragmented cohesive ethnic communities, disrupting traditional governance structures and socio-cultural continuity. Policies such as the Inner Line Regulation (1873) further isolated hill societies, while missionary interventions introduced literacy, Christianity, and political consciousness, contributing to emerging ethnic mobilisation.

The post-independence period witnessed intensified border institutionalisation as India and Burma consolidated territorial sovereignty. The 1967 Indo-Myanmar Boundary Agreement formalised the international border, restricting traditional cross-border mobility. These changes generated economic hardship, identity anxieties, and political alienation, contributing to the rise of ethnic insurgencies. Militant groups such as the NSCN, ULFA, and various Kuki and Meitei organisations exploited Myanmar’s border regions as strategic sanctuaries. Following Myanmar’s 2021 military coup, renewed conflict, refugee influxes, and transnational militancy underscored the enduring relevance of historical ethnic linkages.

Against this background, the decision of the Union government to cancel the Free Movement Regime (FMR) with Myanmar and the fencing of the international border with the neighbouring country aggravated the dissatisfaction among the ethnic groups of the region. On 6 February 2024, India’s Home Minister, Amit Shah, announced that the Union government had decided to fence the 1,643 km-long India-Myanmar border and construct a patrol track along it to “facilitate better surveillance”. He also noted that 10km of the border in Manipur had already been fenced and referred to ongoing work on a pilot

THE
WIDENING OF TENSIONS
BEYOND THE MEITEI-KUKI
DIVIDE SHOWS HOW
unresolved questions
OF LAND, IDENTITY, BORDERS
AND AUTONOMY CONTINUE
TO HAUNT THE
STATE

project to fence one km each in Manipur and Arunachal Pradesh with a “Hybrid Surveillance System (HSS).” Two days later, Shah announced that the government was immediately suspending the Free Movement Regime (FMR) along the India-Myanmar border. Formalised bilaterally by India and Myanmar in 2018, the FMR is a visa-free mobility regime that allows local communities living along both sides of the border to travel back and forth across a 16km zone on each side. A large number of people belonging to the Kuki Zo tribal community organised rallies in Manipur and Mizoram on May 16, 2024, to denounce the government’s decision. The Zo Reunification Organisation (ZORO) and the Mizo Zirlai Pawl (MZP), the apex Mizo students’ body, organised demonstrations to oppose the proposed fencing along the Indo-Myanmar border by the Union Government. In Nagaland, Naga civil society groups, such as the Naga Students’ Federation, have vehemently opposed it because fencing the border would partition the historical Naga land that cuts across the demarcated boundary. In a meeting held on March 16, 2024, the Zo Reunification Organisation (ZORO) and Nagaland Indigenous People’s Forum

(NIPF) have opposed the scrapping of the Free Movement Regime, the implementation of the Citizenship Amendment Act, the Uniform Civil Code, and the implementation of the Armed Forces Special Power Act - AFSPA in the tribal regions of the North-eastern states. The two tribal bodies signed a memorandum of understanding, appealing to the Nagas and Zo ethnic groups to support the MoU and also urging the Government of India to revoke the above-stated acts and laws.

Meiteis: squeezed between Nagas and Kukis

The Meiteis are surrounded by the hills, where there are overlapping claims of ancestral land between the Naga and Kuki communities, as well as demand for separate administrative areas- Greater Nagaland and Kuki-Zo Homeland. While Hindu Meiteis primarily inhabit the small, central Imphal Valley, which makes up about 10 per cent of the state’s total land area, Nagas and Kukis- mostly Christian by religion- reside in the surrounding hill districts, which constitute about 90 per cent of the state’s total land area.

The Meitei insurgency has its origin in Meitei revivalism, which started in 1930 against Hindu Vaishnavism imported from Bengal into Manipur. Subsequent to the accession of Manipur to India, the movement spread and gained prominence under the banner of ‘Meitei Marup’.The present Meitei insurgency traces its origins to the foundation of the United National Liberation Front (UNLF) on November 24, 1964. Radicalism spread further after the formation of the People’s Liberation Army (PLA) in 1978. The PLA has a leftist ideology, and it wanted to unite all ethnic groups in the North East. Meiteis also feel that the denial of Schedule Tribe status led to discontent and an increase in insurgent activities, as employment avenues for Meiteis were reduced significantly.

With the Nagas demanding Naga-dominated areas, the very existence of the state of Manipur was being questioned, which the Meitei population vociferously resisted. On June 14, 2001, the ceasefire between NSCN (IM) and the Centre was extended to all Naga-inhabited areas outside Nagaland. This led to the eruption of an upsurge among the Meiteis. The proposed visit of Th Muivah, the NSCN(IM) leader, to his native village after 47 years, approved by the Central government on April 29, 2010, was perceived by the valley people as a threat to Manipur’s territorial integrity owing to the well-publicised demand of NSCN (IM) for the merger of all Naga inhabited areas into one political unit – Nagalim. The areas in Manipur that NSCN(IM) is demanding be merged with Nagaland as part of greater Nagalim include large areas of Kuki inhabitancy.

Kukis in Manipur consequently felt the need to organise themselves to protect their interests more forcefully. The Kuki State Demand Committee (KSDC) was formed on November 2, 2010, to seek statehood for the Kukis. This Kuki-land / Kuki state is to be carved out of their ancestral land in Manipur. Central to this demand is the motive of historical revenge on the Nagas. The Kukis have made a special demand for integrating all Kuki-Chin territories of Chin State (Myanmar), Chittagong Hill Tracts (CHT), Bangladesh, Mizoram (India), and the Kuki Hills in outer Manipur into one separate country, Zalongam (land of freedom).

Now the Imphal valley of Manipur is squeezed between Greater Nagalim and Zalongam. The Union government looks clueless and has left the helpless citizens to the mercy of the insurgent groups. The Modi government converted the State of Jammu and Kashmir into three Union Territories by dividing the state. To retain control on this vital region, which is considered as the gateway to East Asia, the same strategy may be applied to Manipur also.

WELLNESS

LOVE,
OUTSOURCED?



What happens when your partner speaks to an AI before speaking to you? A new emotional dynamic is reshaping modern relationships

AUTHOR



ERA DUTTA

“My wife and I have been married for four years. Whenever we have a disagreement, she does not talk it through with me first; instead, she goes to ChatGPT. She drafts her messages to me using AI. Last week I found a conversation where she had described our entire argument to it and asked it what to do. I feel replaced. I feel like I am being managed rather than loved. Am I overreacting?”

You are not overreacting. And yes, this is something more and more couples are quietly navigating, usually without a name for it.

Why do people turn to AI after a fight?

Your wife’s behaviour, however unsettling, likely comes from a familiar place: the desire to communicate better. Many people, particularly those who grew up in conflict-averse households, find that organising thoughts before speaking leads to cleaner, less reactive exchanges. AI offers something no human can: unlimited patience, no emotional stake in the outcome, and zero judgment. In fact, it even provides solutions (not always ideal).

This does not mean your feelings are wrong. It means the behaviour has a human logic behind it, even if its impact on you is painful. And it raises a quietly uncomfortable clinical question for people doing this: if you are processing your relationship with an AI rather than with your partner, who is actually in the relationship?

Picture a couple after an argument, the kind that ends not with resolution but with two people on opposite sides of the bed, phones out. One of them types the whole thing into ChatGPT. By morning, the message that arrives feels composed, measured, entirely pre-processed. The partner receiving it senses something is off because it is too polished, too managed, just like being handed a press release instead of a conversation.

When the tool becomes the distance

There is a meaningful difference between using AI to collect your thoughts and using it as your primary emotional confidant. The first is reasonable, but the second quietly hollows a relationship out.

When your most honest, unfiltered feelings of the raw version, before editing, are going to an AI rather than to your partner, your partner is getting the rational highlight gist.

Intimacy researcher John

Gottman describes small daily moments he calls “bids”, which are the imperfect, sometimes clumsy reaches for connection that couples make in distress. The cracked voice, the tearfulness, the “I don’t even know how to explain this, but I’m upset.” Those unpolished moments are not communication failures but are the actual building blocks of closeness. When AI begins receiving them instead, a slow and quiet withdrawal begins, one that is genuinely difficult to explain, and even harder to reverse.

The Indian context In relationships where direct communication has long been complicated by family pressures, gender expectations, and the cultural preference for keeping peace over speaking truth, AI offers something that feels almost unimaginable: a space to say the real thing without consequence. For many women, especially, a ChatGPT conversation may be the first place they have ever articulated what they actually feel about their marriages, their in-laws, and their desires. That is not ordinary. The conversation that matters still needs to happen between two people.

IN THE SEARCH for better communication, many are turning to AI—yet the cost may be the very vulnerability that sustains intimacy

What to do?

If you recognise yourself as the one over-relying on AI for emotional processing, pause and ask honestly: is the technology helping you communicate better with your partner, or helping you avoid the discomfort of doing so? That distinction matters.

If it is your partner you are worried about, the worst response is an ultimatum. “Stop using ChatGPT” misses the point entirely and closes a conversation that needs to open.

Try instead: “I’ve noticed you process things with AI before you come to me. I’m not angry, I’m curious, and honestly, a little hurt. I want to be the person you turn to first, even when it’s messy and sad.” That sentence is harder to say than anything ChatGPT will ever generate. It is also the only one that changes anything, which is open communication.

Couples therapy can also help here, not because the marriage is in crisis, but because a skilled therapist can examine what gaps the AI is filling, and whether those gaps can be closed between the two of you instead.

Don’t let ChatGPT be the third wheel in your relationship.



1
CULTURAL
SHIFT

4
SAFETY
SURGE

∞
DEALERSHIP
GAPS

When SHE Shifts Gears

India’s women are no longer just passengers in the auto story. They are buyers, influencers and the (not so) quiet force defining what India’s cars are becoming

AUTHOR



RAJEEV NARAYAN

It is a rugged return. I remember a time, not too long ago, when Mahindra & Mahindra looked like a company caught between nostalgia and irrelevance. Its rugged DNA, forged in the era of the original Jeep-inspired workhorses, seemed out of place in a market chasing sleek urban crossovers and gadget-laden cabins. Mahindra Auto’s products felt dated, the design language uninspired and the excitement largely missing.

Then, quite abruptly, Mahindra Auto flipped the narrative on its head. So much so, that it is not merely selling SUVs today, it is selling aspirations, dreams and testosterone wrapped in steel, torque and waiting periods long enough to test a buyer’s patience. And loyalty. The launch of the ScorpioN, That Roxx and XUV 7XO did more than boost sales charts; they reignited a brand that had begun to fade into the background noise of India’s hyper-competitive automobile market.

PLAY ON SCARCITY

If there is one unmistakable sign of Mahindra’s resurgence, it is the queues inside and outside its showrooms, and the weather be damned. This is not metaphorical, but real, with waiting periods stretching across months, sometimes over a year. In an industry space where instant gratification is the norm, Mahindra has done something counterintuitive. It has made customers wait. And it has made them like the waiting.

This is not accidental. Analysts have often pointed out that constrained supply, whether by design or circumstance, has amplified desirability. A report by analysts noted how the long waiting periods for the XUV 7XO, Thar Roxx and ScorpioN created a halo effect, elevating all three models into aspirational territory. In a curious twist, delay became demand’s new best friend.



Eulogy aside, scarcity alone does not sell cars; it only sharpens appetite. What Mahindra has managed to do (arguably better than most) is ensure that the product justifies the anticipation. When buyers finally take delivery, the experience validates the hype. Most of the time.

A LEAP IN DESIGN

The real pivot lies beneath the surface. Mahindra’s investments in engineering, design and global talent are paying off in ways that even sceptics find hard to dismiss. The XUV 7XO marked a decisive break from some previous, awkward design experiments. It is bold but not brash, and modern without losing identity. The ScorpioN managed the impossible, reinventing an icon without alienating its loyal base. Thar Roxx made the capable but uncomfortable road-chewer Thar grow some sexy entrails after a fresh round of manicure, pedicure and enema. Worldwide, such balancing acts between legacy and reinvention have seen many automakers stumble. Mahindra has not.

Industry observers have credited this transformation to an integrated product development approach, with inputs from global design studios and a sharper focus on consumer expectations. The result is a line-up that no longer feels like it is playing catch-up. Instead, it sets

benchmarks... be it in road presence, feature lists or sheer visual drama.

THE WAR OF FEATURES

Step inside any Mahindra SUV and the shift becomes apparent. Panoramic sunroofs, advanced driver assistance systems, connected tech, etc. etc. These features were once considered the preserve of plush imports; they are now part of the Mahindra vocabulary. The XUV 7XO’s inclusion of Advanced Driver Assistance Systems (ADAS) was a particularly telling move. It signalled intent. Mahindra was not content with being rugged and no-frills. It wanted to compete (and win) on technology as well.

Yet, this is where the story becomes nuanced. For all its strides, Mahindra’s execution has not been flawless. Early software glitches, niggling quality issues and inconsistent after-sales experiences have occasionally dented the sheen. In a market where word-of-mouth travels faster than any marketing campaign, these are not trivial concerns.

The company seems aware of this lump in its customers’ throats. Recent efforts to streamline service networks and improve customer engagement suggest a recognition that product excellence must be matched by ownership



THE ASCENT OF INDIA’S WOMAN BUYERS IS RESHAPING THE NATION’S CARS – prioritizing SAFETY, USABILITY AND RESPECT OVER DATED NOTIONS OF POWER OR STATURE

experience. Whether that gap closes enough remains to be seen.

A NATION OF SUVs

Mahindra’s resurgence is a story about India itself. After all, this is a country that has fallen head over heels for SUVs, real or imagined. From urban commuters to rural buyers, the SUV has become a symbol of status, safety and, occasionally, stubborn practicality. Mahindra has tapped into this sentiment. Its vehicles are not just modes of transport; they are statements. They promise capability, even if most will never see a dirt trail, and project a rugged masculinity that resonates across demographics.

In doing so, Mahindra has outmanoeuvred competitors who either underestimated the emotional pull of SUVs or diluted it in pursuit of broader appeal. While others chased volume through compromise, Mahindra doubled down on identity.

The question now is whether this mojo is sustainable, or if it was just a well-timed surge.

For the challenges are real. Electrification is no longer a distant prospect but an ongoing disruption. Sure, Mahindra has made ambitious noises, outlining plans for a new generation of electric SUVs, but ambition is the easy part. Execution is where legacies are made or broken, as global auto giants have shown us over the years.

And competition is intensifying. Rivals are not standing still. From Korean giants refining their offerings to Chinese EVs and American muscle recalibrating strategies for India, the battlefield is getting quite crowded. There is also the risk of complacency, the silent killer of resurgence stories. The very success that Mahindra enjoys today could, if unchecked, breed the same inertia that once dragged it down.

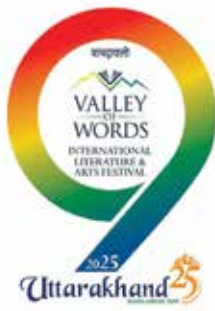
WILL THE U-TURN LAST?

For now, the verdict seems to be that Mahindra Auto has pulled off a most compelling turnaround. It has rediscovered its voice, sharpened its identity and reconnected with the Indian buyer’s psyche. But the road ahead will demand more than momentum. It will require discipline, consistency and the humility and foresight to keep evolving.

For in the unforgiving world of automobiles, mojo is not a destination. It is a moving target. For Mahindra, the test is not whether it got its groove back, but whether it can keep driving it forward.

Soliloquy: A footnote has to be added here. Thar and ScorpioN have become protagonists in ‘street theatre’ across India. There are viral videos of dangerous overtakes, reckless intimidation and a near-feudal sense of entitlement on roads. It would be silly to blame the machine for the misdemeanour, but it is also true that when a brand begins to symbolise aggression along with aspiration, the line between rugged appeal and road menace blurs. For Mahindra and India’s car culture, this is a message: Power, mechanical or social, must come with restraint. On roads as crowded and chaotic as India’s, the true mark of a machine is not how it dominates, but how responsibly it is driven.

Poetry in the In-Between



Jayshree Misra Tripathi's *Twilight Poems* explores visibility and silence, transforming personal memory into universal emotion, urging readers to pause, observe and feel

AUTHOR



SANJEEV CHOPRA

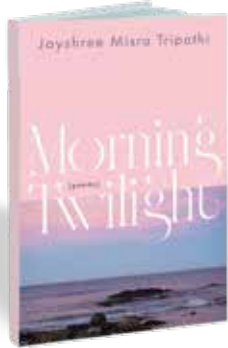
“*Twilight Poems*”, as the name suggests, is a threshold between the private and the public, the moments between daylight and dark, speech and silence, memory and discovery. Jayshree Misra Tripathi’s language is spare and exact, her images are domestic yet capacious, her voice asks us to slow down and notice. In these pages, the soft light is turned inward as ordinary objects are transformed into metaphors of meaning through the quiet courage of attention.

Let me begin with an excerpt from my favourite poem in this collection: “*The Centre and Me*” (needless to say, this is about the India International Centre):

“*This is a safe haven for the likes of me,/ with silver-grey hair/ that dances in the gentle breeze. There is always a kindred soul to greet,/ Programmes to see – dance, music,/ discussions, book launches, art on display – / the hours pass easily./*

Here I am not Invisible./ And my Voice still counts.”

The first point to note is that in these lines, the first letters in Invisible and Voice are capitalized. Secondly, ‘not Invisible’ is different from ‘Visible’. Visibility is a metaphor for competition. It is true that ‘not Invisible’ may be the thesaurus equivalent of Visible, but the connotation and context are so different. To me, Visible is morning and Not Invisible is twilight. Similarly, Voice with a capital V is an indicator of presence. And the IIC itself is a platform for meaningful exchanges, an open and safe space for ideas to grow in healthy discourse. Jayshree’s poem reminds us how a space can be both witness and participant — a keeper of small rituals, of meetings and departures, of the hushed work of listening



that makes public life possible — like being a *Drishta* (viewer) as well as a *Karta* (doer). ‘Invisible’ and ‘Voice’ are a leitmotif in this collection of poems, for in another titled “*A Prayer from a Mother*”, she writes:

“*My voice still counts. I am not invisible./ YET.”*

Before I delve into the book, let me say that its dedication to the author’s women ancestors – the child brides, the child widows, the grandmothers, her mother and mother-in-law – was very touching and took me back to the loving embrace of my own grandmother and her sister, as well as my mother and her sisters

who showered much affection on their ‘first-born son’. Would things have been different if I had a sister – I don’t know, for I am a single child. In this context, the poem “*Woman of India*” becomes representative of how time has transitioned from our grandmothers’ generation to the contemporary moment:

“*Why does this Woman of India/ Love, without condition?/ Why does this Woman of India/ Forgive, without condition?/ How does she grieve?/ Why does she sob behind closed doors?/ When does she soothe her bruises?/ What is she made of? Where can she go?/ A few lines later, Jayshree gives us an answer: “Listen to silver-grey words/ from another Woman of India./ In the era of empowerment,/ fight for your rights - / snap bonds that harm./ Face each onslaught with courage./ Reach out for a helping hand – talk to another, in a safer place./ One Life and you must, and you will, smile again.”*

Let us now get to the offerings of “*Morning Twilight*” in a chronological order, and I will share one or two lines from the poems in each of the book’s seven sections. In the Prologue, we have a poem called “*The Composer of Verse*”:

“*And now, it is MY time to seek/ words in concise measures/ to bait my eccentric fancies,/ perhaps nudge my Muse/ from her stubborn stupor.”*

A faint tinge of regret at having had to sacrifice her academic career to the career ambitions of her diplomat husband comes out as a lament:

“*Once feted scholar turned housewife/ by circumstances, not choice -/ the decades have swept by,/ yoked to others’ needs, complaints.”*

In the section “*Angst*”, the poem “*From a Ladies Coupé*” is about “*the utter stillness of fear on a train journey*” through the Chambal valley, which is later contrasted with “*sad-fishing*” as the new social media malaise “*that mocked genuine vulnerability/ for sharing emotions online*”. There is also a reflective poem “*Why Teach at All?*” which draws from The Loneliness of a Long-distance Runner.

The next section “*Life*” has the wonderful poem “*He Said, She Said*”:

“*It was dawn/that caused the first rift. I saw darkness,/ he saw the light./ Yet we smiled in unison,/ hiding the pain of incompatibility.”*

And there is the sensuous touch in “*Mid-life Blues*”:

“*Will you think of me/ when I am gone?/ The grey in my hair,/ spread of my hips;/ the warmth of my glance,/ and crooked smile,/ with its hint of scorn.”*

The fourth section is called “*Bioscope*”. The most poignant lines are a tribute to the love of her life. As immortalized in the poem “*She Wore White: In Memory of Sibabrata 1955-2017*”:

“*I clenched both palms,/ holding our son’s intangible hand,/ he, on his way from a distant continent./ I held her palm in mine. No. Untrue./ I stood alone, hands ajar, propped/ by the Circle of Friends and Family,/ some that loved us, some who did not,/ some Invisible. How will you know?/*

And there we stood, she and I,/ Trespassers in the Fold of Tradition./ I do believe you would have smiled/ at our stance! Farewell, Farewell./ The End.”

There is a powerful prose poem in the fifth section “*Karmic Lacerations*”; in “*Capital D*”, Jayshree writes:

“*I no longer fear Death with a capital D, for I have weathered a hundred-odd Deaths at three score eight. Yet here I am. Vulnerable. Alone.”*

The penultimate section is called “*Windmills*”. Here we have a poem called “*Solitude*” which Tripathi ends with these three lines:

“*My choices were not for myself./ I crave for the joy of solitude/... to set me free.”*

The last section, appropriately called “*In the End*”, has a poem titled “*In Linear Sequence*”:

“*At birth/ the mind innocent, the heart pure,/ knows no insecurity. At school,/ the mind playful, the heart curious,/ knows not jeopardy. An adolescent, the mind insecure,/ questions fickle amor/ seeks the veracity of promises. As a young lover, the mind/ yearns for permanence./endures vulnerability.*

An adult, the mind matures,/ in matrimony, parenthood,/ learns accountability. The mind now bolder/ yet fraught with fear, the empty nest,/ now seeks serenity. The mind even older, aware/ of latent sorrow, the loss of a loved one,/ seeks tranquility. The mind hardened with known pain,/ Life in all its glory, welcomes harmony./ We are now Complete.”

This is a book to be cherished, to be read at leisure, and to connect with our own individual memories – for at the end of the day, it is this connect to universal experience which makes us truly human. Let us therefore read the book, cover to cover, share it with friends and reflect on the offerings, especially in the twilight hours. It is 4.28 am in Dehradun where I write this, and the twitter of the morning birds is entering my window this morning!

ROOTED IN DEEPLY PERSONAL MEMORY YET RESONANT WITH universal EMOTION, THE COLLECTION TRANSFORMS THE ORDINARY INTO QUIET ACTS OF MEANING

Dignity Beyond Disability

A compelling account by Suchitra Shenoy of the Latika Roy Memorial Foundation, tracing how care evolved into a model of dignity, inclusion and systemic change

AUTHOR



YAUVANIKA CHOPRA

When Mary McGowan came to know of a premature baby abandoned at a government hospital in the Himalayas, she said immediately that her sister would adopt her. Her husband, Tom Synan, was surprised. But Mary’s conviction was correct — her elder sister Jo took one look at the infant in the hospital crib and made instant arrangements to take her to Dehradun, to her husband Ravi Chopra and little children Anand and Cathleen. The baby weighed less than a kilogram and was named Uma after the goddess Parvati, daughter of the Himalayas; affectionately, everyone called her Moy Moy in homage to her aunt Mary. Moy spoke human language for a while, then a language of laughter, and later she spoke only with her eyes and her smile.

When it became clear that Moy had different needs from her siblings (and that Dehradun did not have a school equipped to deal with those needs), Jo decided to work towards a solution. The Latika Roy Memorial Foundation, named after another pioneering teacher who had earlier pursued excellence in Dehradun education, began as a play group and is now a leading service centre for children with special needs. The best way to gauge the success of any organisation is to speak with those who are at the bottom of its hierarchical structure, writes Suchitra Shenoy, and Latika is

a towering example of success in this metric. From the school-van driver Ashok Mangain to female chowkidars Anita and Nisha, the Latika culture of according dignity to all labour has fostered a remarkable vitality.

Harikala “Hema” Sharma was one of Moy Moy’s primary caretakers. Having already seen a great deal of sorrow in her young life, it was Moy with whom she would share her troubles. “And Hema’s problems were not trivial. Poverty, an alcoholic father, a broken engagement she was blamed for, a brother’s suicide, opposition to her choice of husband... it is hard to fathom from Hema’s smiling face how much she has endured. Moy would listen to all this and offer, through her quiet presence, that most essential of human acts: comfort. One can picture them in a quiet corner of the garden, Moy Moy in her stroller, Hema in a colourful kurta chatting away beside her. ‘Moy would comfort me, with her eyes, with her lovely smile. And then,’ Hema says with a lovely smile of her own, ‘I would forget all my troubles.’”

Hema is one of the many “jay-birds” who have perpetuated the acorns of Latika’s oak tree expansion over the years. There are others too, like educational psychologist Nicola Tansley who designed a child-protection policy for the centre and Sumita Nanda who began as a receptionist at Latika and then rose to carry that same policy through in practice as COO Child Protection Officer. “Sumita has incorporated child protection into every part of Latika: teaching, training, recruitment, evaluations. Seasoned staffers, new recruits, interns — all get to learn it, because child protection is not just Sumita’s job, it is everyone’s job.”

Another jay-bird was bureaucrat Keshav Desiraju who supported Latika’s early intervention and assessment centre Gubbara within the premises of Doon Hospital in



THIS IS A STORY OF institution-building ROOTED IN EMPATHY BUT SUSTAINED BY RIGOUR

order to enable comprehensive (and free) reports about each special child’s particular context. The team at Latika later went on to also build an Early Intervention Centre for individualised development plans offered to parents in both Hindi and English, along with the Latika School for children between seven and fourteen with disabilities across a range of severity. There is singing and dancing every day at Latika amidst a culture of participative joy for both staff and students. Special education teachers often go above and beyond in designing lesson plans that will ensure the steady progress of their wards. Young girls at Latika, for

example, have a special menstruation class to which their mothers are also invited, so that teacher and parent can collaborate on how to proceed through this monthly biological shift with as much independence for the child as possible.

After fourteen, children from Latika can join Latika’s Centre for Vocational Training where the “hope is that love, care and practical training will help them find meaningful jobs and some degree of independence.” Whether it is supervised employment in the market or being able to help out around the home, young adults at the centre are empowered with skill-building. But the world outside can remain a battlefield. “In India, which has millions with disabilities, only around 100,000 have found employment outside the government sector (which reserves some jobs for the disabled). It is harder for Latika because its children have multiple disabilities.” Social mingling is one of the key factors in leading a healthy life, and this usually happens for the Latika community through the various clubs at the centre itself for the children and their families.

Not everything can be done

within the walls of Latika. Children live at home with their families, and those who have special needs require special attention. This is not always easy. Even in the case of the Chopras: Ravi abandoned his political dreams because they would have required too much time in Delhi, and Moy’s brother refers candidly to the difficulty which can accompany adjustment of this sort. It may not be easy — but it can be rewarding in ways otherwise impossible to experience.

One in six of us is likely to experience significant disability. There are fewer than 10 paediatric doctors per 100,000 children in India and even fewer who can work with special needs resulting from neurodevelopmental delays, autism, cerebral palsy, Down syndrome, or other learning difficulties affecting cognitive function. Because not everyone can afford to visit Dehradun where Latika provides localised care - although some of the most touching stories in the book are of parents like Savitha Purohit who brave all odds to rebuild here - the centre developed an outreach programme for rural areas with the support of ASHA workers. A collaboration with the Army Welfare Association has also opened up Latika to specialised training for various special-needs schools supported by the Indian Army.

Mention must be made here of the wonderful work now being done in Dehradun by other organisations like the Sharpe Memorial School for the Blind, the Bajaj School of Learning for the Deaf, the Cheshire Home and the Raphael Ryder-Cheshire Home for Children. There is also the Dehradun Disability Forum, through which the Latika team came to know of an intellectually disabled girl named Pooja who was raped in 2012. The persistent efforts of Latika’s “one-man legal army” Rizwan Ali on this case led to two landmark changes in Uttarakhand: one, a cognisance on part of the state government for greater sensitivity by investigating officers (who had earlier forced the victim to share space with the criminal) and two, success in receiving financial compensation for the victim. “While pushing for her money to come through, Rizwan was able to free up not just Pooja’s compensation of two hundred thousand rupees but the compensation money of sixteen other victims.” This is just one reminder in this book of the fact that although much work remains to be done, much is also being accomplished by those who have the quiet conviction which is the foundation to real change.

Faith - in Jesus Christ and Guru Nanak and other spiritual teachers - has been an intuitive direction for Jo Chopra-McGowan. It’s what guided her decision to marry Ravi and later to adopt Moy. “Leap, and the net will appear,” is a saying she believes in. A quote which decorates the walls of the Latika office is by Shunryu Suzuki: “Light up one corner — not the whole world, just make it clear where you are.” Another principle which illuminates the way for Jo and all the others who became part of Moy Moy’s circle, who continue to be moved by her story, is the prayer spoken by the family at every meal: “May those who are hungry have food. And those who have food — hunger for peace and justice on Earth.”

CLIMATE SCIENCE,
POLICY DILEMMA



As climate models grow more complex, their limitations raise critical questions on how reliably they can guide public policy on mitigation and adaptation

AUTHOR



KRISHNA GUPTA

In the last two articles, we discussed the basics of climate model building and the problems therein. We saw that one had to be cautious while applying the outputs of various climate models and their simulations. In this article, we will take a harder look at the gaps between climate models and reality: a task that is straightforward in weather prediction models, but tricky in climate models. We will also discuss how best to apply the results from climate model simulations to serious public policy questions, spanning from mitigation measures in industry and energy to adaptation measures in irrigation, flood control, and agriculture.

A BIG CHASM?

We saw in the earlier articles that climate models are run by 'hindcasting', i.e., by simulating the past. The model's results are then compared with recorded observations of temperature, rainfall, etc., and a close match validates the model. It tells us that the scientific basis and the parameterisation of the model are sound. Climate models can also be run with and without a rise in greenhouse gas emissions, which tells us the effect of greenhouse gases on temperature and other variables. Finally, climate models also help us distinguish natural variability from human-induced variability. But the problem with 'hindcasting', or simulating the past climate, is that models can be compared with only one climate that unfolded in the past. There is no way to analyse and compare with other possible ways in which the past climate would have unfolded. Another problem is that while assessing a climate model, the same data is used which was available to the model builder: what David Stainforth has called the 'in-sample' problem. As Stainforth says, the best we can do is be aware of the limitations of the model while using it.

However, we still have a problem: even if a model is robust in terms of yielding valid results of past simulations, we still cannot say for sure that the model will predict the future climate with the same robustness. The reasons for this are that there

can be multiple pathways to the future climate. Further, since climate change is a reality, we are reasonably certain that the climate will behave very differently in the future: not only are we unsure of the nature of future climate change, we are even more uncertain about its rate. Finally, there is no way to test climate prediction decades from now: note that this is very different from 10-day weather forecasts, which can be tested easily, since observations are available in a short time.

In the Coupled Model Intercomparison Program (CMIP), many simulations of the past have been run and compared with actual observations. This has been done at both the global and regional levels. Even the global annual average temperature, or the average annual temperatures at regional levels, have seen a wide divergence between actual observations and those that have come from past simulations. It appears that climate models do not really give us accurate measures of the actual climate system. It follows that climate models, in their current form, may not help much with climate prediction. They may confirm broad trends about global warming as a result of greenhouse gas emissions, or that

rainfall across the world will become more erratic in its frequency and intensity—but these are broadly what science would also tell us. When it comes to predicting precise climate events, such as average annual temperatures in a particular city or the intensity of rainfall in a coastal town, climate models may have their constraints.

There is no easy answer to this conundrum: some say that the models need to become more sophisticated, with higher resolution and greater complexity. But again, there is no consensus on where to stop. However, all is not lost: climate models can still be useful in helping answer public policy questions. We will discuss more of this in the coming articles.

CONCLUSION

Climate models have become increasingly complex over the years, with the availability of more computing power. However, climate models remain a work in progress. They have limitations in predicting the climate, and even 'hindcasting' poses its problems. Nevertheless, climate models can be useful in understanding the climate system and also provide pointers to policy issues from the many simulations of the future.

Stars,
Swing
and
Supremacy

From Kohli's command presence to Bhuvneshwar's enduring swing, IPL 2026 is less about spectacle and more about structure, clarity, and execution—areas where some teams thrive while others visibly falter

AUTHOR



S KANNAN

The 2026 edition of the Indian Premier League is turning out to be a delight for those who romance statistics in cricket. Around 15 years back, when the IPL was still young, people said it was nothing more than 'pyjama' club cricket played under the arc lights. Today, when seasoned pros and bubbly youngsters are catching the eye, it ensures the visibility of the IPL stays constantly high.

One does not need to look at viewing figures alone. Sometimes, numbers alone cannot reflect the emotions in a match. What matters to the hardcore fans is the energy in a match. A unique instance of a match happening in New Delhi at the good old Ferozeshah Kotla, rechristened as the Arun Jaitley Stadium, and yet fans waiting more to see the rival side do well is a reality.

To cut the suspense, fans thronged the arena near Delhi Gate to see Virat Kohli in action, more than anyone else. Imagine a boy born in West Delhi, having learnt all the nuances of cricket in the Capital and now paying visits to his hometown only once in a while—it is surprising. Yet, one needs to know, such is the aura of Kohli, and how he energises the entire Royal Challengers Bengaluru team, fans do not mind it even if their 'home' side, Delhi Capitals, is at the receiving end.

To be sure, fans of the IPL are not hooked to team loyalty alone, unless it is the Chennai Super Kings. One has seen in the 2026 edition of the IPL that Indian stars are more in the news by sheer weight of performance. The chatter is as much over Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, just 15, who sets the arena ablaze when he turns out for Rajasthan Royals. Such has been his impact on the game that people are asking if Sachin Tendulkar was also so robust at the same age.

Comparisons in cricket will never end. A Vaibhav Sooryavanshi for the Rajasthan Royals and Abhishek Sharma turning out for Sunrisers Hyderabad is exciting. At the same time, Down South, the way Sanju Samson has been firing for CSK is also an indication that he will be there with the Chennai franchise for a long time.

If one thought the Young Turks are the flavour, what Virat Kohli has done is something magnificent. To cross 9,000 runs in the IPL at the age of 36 defines his aura and stage presence. Most importantly, there is nothing like showing off; he performs with the bat and inspires the RCB side. At a time when captains of various teams are under the scanner, King Kohli has rightly chosen to play a mentor role as well, which is pronounced.

At this stage of his career, he is

enjoying every bit of his club cricket, which is defined by 9,000 runs plus his approach. He does not take it lightly at all, and the commitment to the team cause in various ways is captivating. In international cricket, Kohli has played under MS Dhoni mainly. There is a rub-off effect in how Kohli learnt and is now willing to impart valuable lessons to RCB captain Rajat Patidar, as well as the fast bowlers in the side.

For those who say the IPL is all about batters clobbering bowlers and that there is nothing in the track for the bowlers, the Kotla was a revelation. The RCB versus Delhi Capitals match is still being discussed for the way two swing bowlers, past their prime and in their mid-30s, showed how to swing the ball in adverse conditions. How Bhuvneshwar Kumar still makes the white ball wobble and strike is a treat to watch. The way Bhuv and Josh Hazlewood decimated the Delhi Capitals was outstanding. Imagine a city reeling under a heat wave saw these two consummate swing bowlers in their elements. This is where Kohli was egging on the two opening bowlers as they wrecked the Delhi Capitals in the Powerplay. Bhuv is the master of swing and is happy to be playing his trade in the IPL. But for Hazlewood to plot the dismissal of KL Rahul, courtesy advice from Kohli, was an eye-opener. The former India captain was pointing to the spot where the Aussie had to land the ball. Sure enough, Rahul was trapped in a planned strategy.

It takes a genius like Virat Kohli to show how much he is part of RCB. And for him to demonstrate all this in Delhi, against the Delhi Capitals, nobody minds it. Any sport, notably the leagues, is all about being part of the side. Kohli loves Delhi for what he learned from this city at a young age. Yet, when he is playing in the same city against a rival side, his energy levels are

so different. For those who marvel at Kohli, one needs to look at Bhuv and his contributions in the IPL. To cross 200 wickets in this gruelling format as a medium pacer has not been easy. Commentators and former cricketers keep saying the IPL is a death knell for bowlers. Someone like Jasprit Bumrah has struggled this season for the Mumbai Indians.

Imagine the nation's most dreaded bowler is being whacked these days by all and sundry. In contrast, Bhuv has nothing to lose and produces such a wonderful swing that he flummoxes batters.

Born in Meerut and having played good international cricket for India across all three formats—Tests, ODIs and T20 internationals—Bhuv does not mind that he is no longer part of Team India.



His last international appearance was four years back. And yet, if there is a true legend as a bowler in the IPL, it has to be Bhuvneshwar Kumar. Away from international cricket, staying fit and sharp is not easy. But then, the IPL is about commitment and preparation.

A bowler's skills never fade away.

They rely on memory and how they have worked towards this stage of becoming a champion. Bhuv has treated the white ball specially, keeping it clean, shining on one side and then making it wobble. For those who can see the prodigious swing, even in the harsh conditions of the IPL, where there is nothing in the wicket, Bhuv is a class act. That he is with the right team—RCB—is also important. By now, it is clear that RCB is a side where players are respected and trusted. For the veterans like Virat Kohli and Bhuvneshwar Kumar to be part of the Bengaluru franchise with pride says a lot.

The ownership of the team has changed, yet, on the field, RCB looks like a composite side. There is a calm and cool feeling on the side, where players do not feel the heat. For such a thing to happen, men behind the scenes are important as well. Andy Flower's presence as head coach, along with Dinesh Karthik's presence as batting coach, is important. At the same time, Omkar Salvi as bowling coach, also has an important role to play.

Look at how some top-heavy sides like the Mumbai Indians, Lucknow Super Giants and Delhi Capitals are struggling. In comparison, RCB appear teflon-coated. What one sees in a match is just one part. Preparation for a match involves a lot more, which is lacking in the Mumbai, Delhi and Lucknow franchises. Just imagine, the Mumbai Indians are loaded with so many stars, and yet there is no synergy. For the record, even Sachin Tendulkar is part of the MI side. What baffles fans is how the Mumbai side is just not able to do anything worthwhile, with so many star players in the ranks and a support staff that is paid handsomely.

As for the Delhi Capitals, this concept of shared ownership between GMR and JSW is weird. Forget synergy; there is something amiss big time, with unknown names in coaching and mentorship roles. Perhaps that is why Axar Patel looks clueless as a captain and is unable to deliver. His confidence level is at an all-time low. Patel's comments after losing to RCB were almost like an apology. As the Indian T20 vice-captain, Patel does not seem to have anyone to fall back on in the Delhi Capitals who can guide him.

With the passing of each day in IPL 2026, it is becoming clear that the difference between performing teams and non-performing teams is worrying. Nobody wants to see a tournament where, by the mid-stage, the bottom half resembles rubble. For sheer intensity, RCB, Punjab Kings, Rajasthan Royals and Sunrisers Hyderabad have surged ahead.

TO CROSS
9,000
RUNS IN THE IPL AT THE AGE OF
36 DEFINES KOHLI'S AURA
AND STAGE PRESENCE

